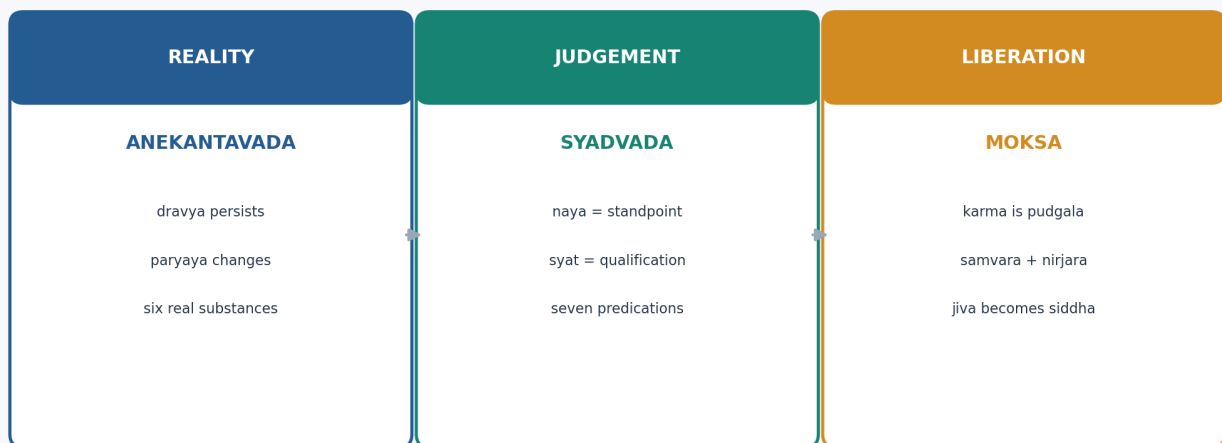


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

JAINISM - Layered Complete Learning Session - Syllabus Item 13

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

JAINISM: MANY-SIDED REALITY, QUALIFIED SPEECH, LIBERATION



sat = origination + decay + permanence

Metaphysics grounds logic; disciplined conduct stops influx and sheds material karma.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

JAINISM - Layered Complete Learning Session - Syllabus Item 13

Syllabus (verbatim): Jainism : Theory of Reality; Saptabhanginaya; Bondage and Liberation. **Evidence key:** FACT: canonical doctrine · ANALYSIS: analytical synthesis · CAUTION: contested/uncertain **Placement:** A recurring UPSC favorite because it combines metaphysics, logic of conditional predication, and a distinctive doctrine of karmic bondage and liberation.

How to use this layered session

Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

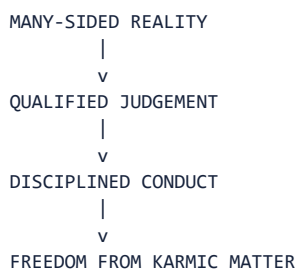
Source audit: the repository Jainism knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 PYQ bank were checked; local OCR-searchable chapters in Chatterjee-Datta and C. D. Sharma were directly inspected. A live 2026 search found contemporary discussion of *anekāntavāda* and *sallekhanā*, used only as labelled conceptual application rather than doctrinal authority. Qdrant was not required.

Preservation note: every substantive section of the previous complete Jainism session is retained below. The new material provides simpler gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing the original depth.

Progress: 1 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: System Map, Textual Anchor and the Jaina Project

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the three connected pillars



In simple words: Jainism is one connected philosophical system. Reality contains many genuine aspects; finite knowers see only some of them; statements must therefore be qualified; and right knowledge must transform conduct so that karmic bondage can end.

First anchor	Easy meaning
<i>Tattvārthasūtra</i>	Shared systematic text for the major Jaina traditions
Three jewels	Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct
Tirthaṅkara	Liberated teacher and ford-maker, not a creator God
Central movement	Reality -> knowledge -> conduct -> liberation

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP

JAINISM

- |
- + - SOURCE ANCHOR
 - | + Tattvārthasūtra: ratna-traya, tattvas, dravyas, jñāna, liberation
- |
- + - THEORY OF REALITY
 - | + Anekāntavāda (anekantavada): reality is many-sided
 - | + Dravya = sat = utpāda + vyaya + dhrauvya
 - | + Six dravyas: jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla
 - | + Pañcāstikāya: five extended substances; kāla is an-astikāya
 - | + Guṇa (qualities) + paryāya (modes)
- |
- + - EPISTEMOLOGY
 - | + Pratyakṣa vs parokṣa, with the Jaina inversion trap
 - | + Five jñānas: mati, śruta, avadhi, mañhpariyāya, kevala
 - | + Partial kṣāyopāśamika knowledge grounds nayavāda and syādvāda
- |
- + - THEORY OF JUDGEMENT
 - | + Nayavāda: partial standpoints
 - | + Syādvāda: conditional predication
 - | + Saptabhaṅgī: sevenfold judgement
- |
- + - SOTERIOLOGY
 - | + Seven tattvas / nine padārthas
 - | + Karma = subtle material pudgala; eight karma-prakṛtis
 - | + Āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa
 - | + Bhāva-bandha + dravya-bandha; four bandha-parameters
 - | + Guṇasthānas: fourteen stages, including sayoga-kevali
 - | + Three jewels + vows + sallekhanā lead to kevala-jñāna and liberation

0A. UMĀSVĀTĪ / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA FACT:

Statement. FACT: The *Tattvārthasūtra* or *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra* of **Umāsvātī** in Śvetāmbara usage and **Umāsvāmī** in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: It gives a compact doctrinal grammar for Jaina metaphysics, epistemology, ethics, bondage, and liberation.
2. FACT: Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.
3. FACT: It states the path through the **ratna-traya** (three jewels): **samyag-darśana** (right vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyak-cāritra** (right conduct).
4. FACT: It systematizes the seven tattvas, the five astikāyas plus kāla, and the classification of jñāna without reducing Jainism to only ethics or only logic.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A UPSC answer improves when Jainism is presented as a systematic darśana rather than as a loose collection of ascetic practices.

Distinction. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers and ford-makers, not creator Gods; Jainism remains **anīśvaravāda** (non-theistic about creation).

Example. FACT: The famous formulation that right vision, right knowledge, and right conduct together constitute the path to mokṣa may be safely used without inventing a sūtra number.

Objection (sectarian-history objection). CAUTION: A critic may ask whether a text accepted by both Śvetāmbaras and Digambaras erases real sectarian differences.

Reply. ANALYSIS: It does not erase them; it supplies a shared doctrinal framework within which disagreements about canon, practice, and interpretation can still remain.

Names to drop carefully. FACT:

- FACT: **Kundakunda**: Digambara thinker associated with *Samayasāra* and the **niścaya-naya / vyavahāra-naya** distinction.
- FACT: **Siddhasena Divākara** and **Samantabhadra**: important names in the early logic of anekānta and syādvāda.
- FACT: **Akalaṅka**, **Māṇikyanandi**, **Hemacandra**, and **Yaśovijaya**: major later Jaina logicians to cite for the mature pramāṇa tradition.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced synthesis

The cross-sectarian standing of the *Tattvārthasūtra* supplies a common doctrinal grammar without erasing Śvetāmbara-Digambara differences. This matters methodologically: cite the text as a shared systematic anchor, but do not infer complete uniformity of canon or practice. Tīrthaṅkaras are perfected teachers rather than creators, so Jaina religious authority remains compatible with an uncreated cosmos.

The deeper philosophical architecture is reciprocal. Metaphysical many-sidedness explains epistemic partiality; epistemic discipline supports ethical non-violence in thought; ethical purification removes the karmic obstruction that prevents complete knowledge. Treating these as unrelated chapters misses the system's unity.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- Use this system map as the introduction to any 15- or 20-marker.
- A high-scoring opening states that Jainism is **pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage**.
- Do not spend more than two or three lines on sectarian history unless the question specifically asks for sources.
- The nine verified topic-owned PYQs are solved in the complete practice section and separate workbook.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Textual anchor: Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī and the *Tattvārthasūtra*.
- Path: *samyag-darśana* + *samyag-jñāna* + *samyak-cāritra*.
- No creator God; liberated teachers remain numerically distinct souls.
- Never reduce Jainism to either "seven viewpoints" or "non-violence" alone.

Progress: 2 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Theory of Reality: Anekānta, Dravya and the Sixfold Pluralism

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - permanence without freezing change

GOLD BRACELET
|
| reshaped
v
GOLD RING

gold persists	= dhrauvya
bracelet-mode ends	= vyaya
ring-mode begins	= utpada

In simple words: a real thing can remain the same substance while its modes change. Jainism refuses both extremes: reality is neither a motionless block nor a series with no enduring identity.

Term	Easy meaning
<i>Dravya</i>	Enduring substance
<i>Guṇa</i>	Stable quality belonging to it
<i>Paryāya</i>	Changing mode or condition
<i>Anekāntavāda</i>	A real has many objective aspects
Six <i>dravyas</i>	Soul, matter, motion-medium, rest-medium, space and time

Memory line: the substance persists while modes originate and decay.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

1. THEORY OF REALITY FACT:

1.1 Anekāntavāda as metaphysical thesis

Statement. FACT: **Anekāntavāda** is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

Argument. FACT:

1. Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.
2. Human cognition usually grasps only one aspect at a time.
3. Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.
4. A sound metaphysics must allow plurality of aspects within one real.
5. Hence reality is non-one-sided, or *anekānta*.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Being is richer than any single finite judgement.

Distinction. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not mere indecision. It is a **metaphysical** claim about the complexity of reality, not yet the logical form of predication.

Example. FACT: A jar is permanent as a substance across a short stretch, changing in modes, describable by shape, use, material, and temporal state. No one predicate says all of this at once.

Objection (skeptical objection). FACT: If every object has indefinitely many aspects, knowledge may become impossible.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina thought replies that knowledge is possible precisely through qualified standpoints, not through absolutist simplification.

1.2 Dravya as sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya FACT:

Statement. FACT: The real (**sat**) is what possesses **utpāda** (origination), **vyaya** (decay), and **dhrauvya** (persistence or permanence) together.

Argument. FACT:

1. Experience shows change: forms arise and pass.
2. Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.
3. Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.
4. Pure flux cannot explain identity.
5. Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.
6. This is articulated by saying substance is characterized by origination, decay, and permanence.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Both common-sense identity and experiential change are philosophically significant and must be preserved.

Distinction. FACT: This differs from Buddhist momentariness, which gives primacy to flux, and from strict monisms that absorb change into mere appearance.

Example. FACT: A gold ornament changes from bracelet to ring: modes originate and cease, yet the underlying substance persists.

Objection (Buddhist/Nyāya-style objection). FACT: How can opposite features—change and permanence—belong to one thing?

Reply. FACT: They belong in different respects: permanence as dravya, change as paryāya.

1.3 Six dravyas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically recognizes **six dravyas**: **jīva**, **pudgala**, **dharma**, **adharma**, **ākāśa**, and **kāla**.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The classification accounts for consciousness, matter, motion, rest, spatial accommodation, and temporal succession.
2. FACT: Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.
3. FACT: Five of the six dravyas are **astikāyas** (extended substances with many space-points or **pradeśas**).
4. FACT: **Kāla** (time) is a real dravya in the mainstream sixfold presentation, but it is **not** an astikāya; hence Jainism speaks of **pañcāstikāya** plus kāla.

The six dravyas. FACT:

Dravya	Basic sense	Role
Jīva	conscious substance	experiencer, knower, bearer of bondage and liberation
Pudgala	matter	corporeality, karmic matter, bodies, sense-objects
Dharma	medium of motion	condition making movement possible
Adharma	medium of rest	condition making rest possible
Ākāśa	space	accommodation for substances
Kāla	time	succession, change, sequence

Astikāya table. FACT:

Dravya	Astikāya ?	Function	Extension
Jīva	FACT: Yes	knowing, experiencing, agency, bondage and liberation	FACT: Has pradeśas; in embodied existence it is co-extensive with the body
Pudgala	FACT: Yes	material bodies, sense-objects, speech, breath, karma-pudgala	FACT: Extended and aggregative
Dharma-dravya	FACT: Yes	medium enabling motion	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa
Adharma-dravya	FACT: Yes	medium enabling rest	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa
Ākāśa	FACT: Yes	gives room or accommodation to substances	FACT: Extended as lokākāśa and alokākāśa
Kāla	WRONG: No	succession, duration, before-and-after, change	FACT: A dravya but an-astikāya because it lacks spatial extension across many pradeśas in the astikāya sense

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Reality is irreducibly pluralistic, and extension must be distinguished from substantiality.

Distinction. FACT: **Dharma** and **adharma** here do **not** mean moral merit and demerit; they mean media of motion and rest.

Sectarian note. FACT: The safe doctrinal point is: **kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya**; the pañcāstikāya list has five members, while the dravya list has six. CAUTION: A common sectarian nuance is that Digambara authors characteristically affirm real **kāla-aṇus** (time-atoms) associated with the space-points of lokākāśa, whereas some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of kāla as disputed or conventional.

Example. FACT: A fish swims because water is the medium enabling motion; analogically, dharma-dravya is the cosmic condition enabling movement, not motion itself.

Objection (Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika-style objection). FACT: Dharma and adharma as “media” look mysterious and unparsimonious.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina metaphysics treats them not as pushes or forces but as enabling conditions required for a coherent pluralistic cosmology.

1.4 Guṇa and paryāya FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every dravya possesses **guṇa** (essential qualities) and **paryāya** (modes or modifications).

Argument. FACT:

1. A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.
2. It must also undergo modal change or it would not participate in experience.
3. Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ontology must distinguish what remains from how it appears or changes.

Distinction. FACT: **Guṇa** is not the same as **paryāya**: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.

Example. FACT: Consciousness is a defining feature of jīva; pleasure, pain, delusion, or liberated omniscience are modes or conditions in which the jīva appears.

Objection (Buddhist nominalist objection). FACT: Why not just speak of changing qualities rather than introduce a substance?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Because changing qualities still presuppose something whose changes they are.

1.5 Jīva and ajīva FACT:

Statement. FACT: The most fundamental ontological distinction is between **jīva** (conscious) and **ajīva** (non-conscious).

Argument. FACT:

1. Experience distinguishes living, aware beings from inert entities.
2. This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.
3. Hence the universe divides into jīva and ajīva.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Consciousness is real and fundamental, not epiphenomenal.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman. Unlike Cārvāka, consciousness is not reducible to material organization.

Example. FACT: The body, speech, and even karmic matter belong to ajīva; the conscious experiencer bound by them is jīva.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: If jīva is immaterial, how can material karma affect it?

Reply. ANALYSIS: This becomes the central challenge in Jaina bondage theory and is answered through the doctrine of karmic influx and adhesion, though critics find the relation obscure.

1.6 Nature of jīva FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

Argument. FACT:

1. Liberation is meaningful only if the soul has a native capacity to realize perfection.

2. Bondage is then understood as obscuration, not total annihilation of that nature.
3. Therefore jīva is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Spiritual progress presupposes a real self capable of purification.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is pluralistic: there are many jīvas, not one universal self. It also differs from Nyāya, where the self is conscious through conjunction with mind; in Jainism consciousness belongs intrinsically to jīva.

Example. FACT: Souls are graded from one-sense beings to five-sense beings; even minute living entities are morally significant.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is naturally omniscient, ignorance becomes hard to explain.

Reply. FACT: Karma as obscuring matter is introduced precisely to explain the discrepancy between intrinsic capacity and empirical limitation.

1.7 Pudgala FACT:

Statement. FACT: Pudgala is the material dravya and the only dravya possessing rūpa (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.

Argument. FACT:

1. Corporeality, extension, and sensible quality require a material substrate.
2. Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.
3. Since karmic bondage has quasi-physical efficacy, karmic particles too are classed under pudgala.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Materiality is not illusory; it is an objective domain with its own laws.

Distinction. FACT: Pudgala is uniquely important because unlike jīva it is divisible, aggregative, and form-bearing.

Example. FACT: The body I inhabit, the food I consume, the dust in air, and karmic accretions all belong to pudgala.

Objection (Nyāya/Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: To call karma matter seems strange.

Reply. FACT: That strangeness is also Jainism's originality: bondage is not merely moral description but a real quasi-physical entanglement.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections, replies and comparisons

Contradiction objection: how can permanence and change belong to one real? The Jaina reply indexes them to different ontological dimensions: permanence belongs to substance, while origination and decay belong to modes. This anticipates the broader strategy of standpoint qualification.

Buddhist challenge: an enduring substrate may appear unnecessary if causal continuity explains identity. Jainism replies that change is intelligible as the change of something and that a real bearer better explains responsibility and liberation.

Advaita challenge: plurality may be only empirical appearance. Jainism treats difference, matter and individual souls as ultimately real; liberation does not dissolve numerical individuality.

Nyāya challenge: dharma-dravya and adharma-dravya look unparsimonious. The Jaina defence treats them as enabling media, not forces or moral properties. The hardest remaining burden is the interaction of conscious jīva with material pudgala.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2019, Q6(a), 20 marks: define reality through utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya, explain dravya-guṇa-paryāya, then show how this ontology requires qualified judgement.

2025, Q7(c), 15 marks: establish realism through mind-independent substances and pluralism through the six dravyas and many individual souls; then evaluate objections.

For comparison answers, use one axis at a time: permanence/change, number of ultimate realities, status of difference, self, and liberation.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

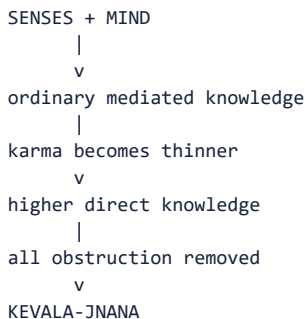
Rapid recall

- *Sat* = origination + decay + permanence.
- Six *dravyas*; five are *astikāyas*, while *kāla* is a *dravya* but not an *astikāya*.
- *Dharma* and *adharma* mean media of motion and rest, not merit and sin.
- *Jīva* is intrinsically conscious; *pudgala* alone possesses form and includes karmic matter.
- Trap: many-sided reality is objective pluralism, not subjective relativism.

Progress: 3 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Jaina Epistemology: Knowledge, Standpoints and the Omniscience Problem

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - why ordinary seeing is not the highest direct knowledge



In simple words: Jainism calls the soul's unmediated cognition truly direct. Ordinary perception depends on senses and mind, so it is direct only in everyday usage. As karmic obstruction decreases, wider forms of knowledge become possible.

Knowledge	Simple role
<i>Mati</i>	Sense-and-mind cognition
<i>Śruta</i>	Verbal or scriptural cognition
<i>Avadhi</i>	Limited direct knowledge beyond ordinary senses
<i>Manaḥpariyāya</i>	Direct cognition of mental states
<i>Kevala</i>	Complete unobstructed knowledge

Memory line: knowledge is intrinsic to the soul but limited by karmic obstruction.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

1A. JAINA PRAMĀṆA SCHEME: THE EPISTEMIC GROUND OF ANEKĀNTAVĀDA FACT:

1A.1 Primary division: *pratyakṣa* and *parokṣa* FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology distinguishes ***pratyakṣa*** (direct knowledge) and ***parokṣa*** (indirect knowledge), but it uses the word *pratyakṣa* in a high-yield, non-ordinary way.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: In the strict Jaina sense, **pratyakṣa** means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.
2. FACT: Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only **sāṃvyaavahārika pratyakṣa** (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).
3. FACT: Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense-organs, mind, signs, and karmic limitation.
4. ANALYSIS: This reverses the usual classroom expectation that perception is the primary direct pramāṇa.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Directness is measured by freedom from mediation and karmic obstruction, not merely by sensory vividness.

Distinction. FACT: Do not map Jaina pratyakṣa mechanically onto Nyāya pratyakṣa; the same term carries a different doctrinal weight.

Example. FACT: Seeing a pot with the eyes is conventionally direct in ordinary dealings, but **kevala-jñāna** is direct in the strict spiritual sense.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya may object that perception through sense-contact is the paradigm of direct cognition.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that sense-contact is direct only pragmatically; metaphysically it is mediated by organs, mind, and knowledge-obscuring karma.

1A.2 Five kinds of jñāna FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of **jñāna** (knowledge): **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Jñāna	Status	Meaning	UPSC trap
Mati-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa / conventional	sense-and-mind cognition	FACT: Ordinary perception is not strict pratyakṣa
Śruta-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa	scriptural, verbal, or sign-mediated knowledge derived from mati	FACT: Not blind faith; it depends on cognition and communication
Avadhi-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa	limited clairvoyant direct knowledge of material things	FACT: Direct but limited
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa	direct knowledge of others' mental modes	FACT: Higher than avadhi, still not omniscience
Kevala-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa	unlimited, unmediated omniscience	FACT: The full overcoming of cognitive obstruction

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.
2. FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala are direct because the soul knows without ordinary sense-and-mind mediation.
3. FACT: The series shows graded release from karmic veiling.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Knowledge is graded according to the degree to which karmic obscuration is removed.

Distinction. FACT: The five jñānas are not five independent pramāṇas in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.

Example. FACT: A student's study of doctrine uses mati and śruta; the kevalin's omniscience is immediate and total.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala appear unverifiable to ordinary experience.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism treats them as necessary consequences of its soul-karma theory; a critic may still reject them if the ontology of jīva and karmic obstruction is denied.

1A.3 Wrong cognition: ajñāna under mithyā-darśana FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism recognizes **mati-ajñāna** or **kumati**, **śruta-ajñāna** or **kuśruta**, and **vibhaṅga-jñāna** as wrong cognition.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.
2. FACT: Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under **mithyā-darśana** (false vision or wrong orientation).
3. FACT: **Kumati** is misoriented sensory-mental cognition; **kuśruta** is misoriented verbal or scriptural cognition; **vibhaṅga-jñāna** is perverted avadhi.
4. ANALYSIS: The content may have some descriptive accuracy, but its orientation is false because it is governed by delusion.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Epistemology and ethics interpenetrate: how one is disposed affects how one knows.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina error is not only logical mistake; it can be a karmically conditioned mode of seeing.

Example. FACT: A learned person may quote doctrine but use it for pride, sectarian contempt, or violence; the verbal cognition then functions as kuśruta.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Calling cognition wrong because of spiritual orientation seems to confuse truth with moral psychology.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that bondage affects the knower as a whole; epistemic correctness without right vision remains incomplete for liberation.

1A.4 Later Jaina logic and indirect pramāṇas ANALYSIS:

Statement. FACT: Jainism admits **anumāna** (inference) and **śabda** (testimony or verbal authority) within parokṣa, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of indirect knowledge.

Argument. ANALYSIS:

1. FACT: **Akalaṅka**, **Māṇikyanandi**, **Hemacandra**, and **Yaśovijaya** are important names for the developed Jaina pramāṇa tradition.
2. ANALYSIS: Later Jaina logicians accept **smṛti** (recollection), **pratyabhijñā** (recognition), **tarka** or **ūha** (reasoning that grasps pervasion or vyāpti), and **anumāna** as valid indirect knowledge in appropriate contexts.
3. FACT: This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.
4. ANALYSIS: The Jaina move protects continuity, recognition, and inferential preparation as genuine cognitive achievements without making them omniscient knowledge.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Valid cognition need not be restricted to fresh sense-contact; mediated cognition can still disclose real features of the object.

Distinction. FACT: **Śabda** is accepted as mediated knowledge, not as a creator-God's revelation; Jainism remains non-theistic about cosmic creation.

Example. FACT: Recognizing "this is the same teacher I met earlier" is not mere raw perception; it involves memory and recognition.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya can argue that memory merely reproduces past knowledge and is not a new pramāṇa.

Reply. ANALYSIS: The Jaina reply is that recollection and recognition can be valid cognition when they successfully connect present awareness with a real object or past experience.

1A.5 Critical link: pramāṇa -> nayavāda -> syādvāda FACT:

Statement. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Reality is **ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu**: the real object has infinitely many aspects, properties, and modes.

2. FACT: Ordinary human cognition is **kṣāyopaśamika** (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and is therefore necessarily partial.
3. FACT: A judgment made by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole object.
4. FACT: A partial judgment is true only relative to its standpoint; this is **nayavāda**.
5. FACT: Absolutising a partial standpoint yields **ekāntavāda** (one-sidedness), the root error of rival schools according to Jainism.
6. FACT: Therefore assertion must carry the operator **syāt** ("from a certain standpoint"); this is **syādvāda**.
7. FACT: The sevenfold schema of qualified predication is the disciplined expression of that standpoint-relativity; this is **saptabhaṅgī**.
8. FACT: Only **kevala-jñāna** grasps all aspects at once, because only omniscience is no longer karmically partial.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Finite cognition is not false simply because it is partial; it becomes false when it claims unconditioned finality.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina relativity is not subjectivism: the aspects are really in the object, but finite knowers access them partially.

Example. FACT: "The jar exists" is true with respect to its present substance-mode-place-time complex, but false with respect to another place, another time, or another incompatible mode.

Objection (Śaṃkara-style objection). FACT: If all assertions are standpoint-relative, the assertion of standpoint-relativity may also lose absolute force.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism accepts reflexive qualification: syādvāda too is asserted **syāt**, and its force lies in disciplined anti-absolutism rather than in an unqualified dogma.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced evaluation

The Jaina inversion of ordinary terminology is a frequent source of error: strict *pratyakṣa* is independent of senses and mind, whereas ordinary sensory cognition is conventionally direct but philosophically mediated. This scheme supports non-absolutism because finite embodied knowledge is partial, not because objects are unreal.

The strongest external difficulty concerns higher cognition and omniscience. These states organise the system's account of complete truth, but they are difficult to verify from an ordinary standpoint. A second difficulty is circularity: complete knowledge validates the many-sided system, while the system explains why complete knowledge exists. The Jaina reply appeals to graded removal of obscuring karma, but the evidential burden remains.

Do not equate epistemic humility with universal scepticism. A standpoint is assessable by whether it captures a real aspect; not every claim is equally valid.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The epistemology is essential to the **2023, Q5(a), 10 marks** quotation on empirical and relative knowledge. Test the quotation rather than accepting it: ordinary embodied cognition is relative, but Jainism admits non-sensory direct knowledge and *kevala-jñāna*.

In a 15-marker, move through: classification of knowledge -> karmic limitation -> partial standpoints -> conditional predication -> omniscience qualification -> critical burden.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

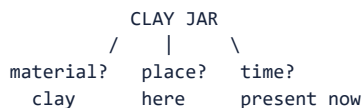
- Strict Jaina *pratyakṣa* is soul-direct, not ordinary sense perception.
- *Mati* and *śrūta* are ordinary mediated cognition.
- *Avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya* and *kevala* are increasingly direct.

- Partial knowledge explains *naya*; it does not make external reality subjective.
- Trap: "all Jaina knowledge is empirical and relative" is false because of *kevala-jñāna*.

Progress: 4 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Nayavāda, Syādvāda and Saptabhāṅgī

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - one object, several valid questions



"It exists" is incomplete until the respect is stated.

In simple words: the same jar can exist here, fail to exist elsewhere, persist as clay, and change as a particular shape. Jainism asks us to attach the hidden condition to every claim rather than turning one partial truth into the whole truth.

Doctrine	Job
<i>Anekāntavāda</i>	Reality has many aspects
<i>Nayavāda</i>	A judgement selects a partial standpoint
<i>Syādvāda</i>	The assertion is explicitly qualified
<i>Saptabhāṅgī</i>	Seven ordered combinations of is, is-not and inexpressible

Memory line: many-sided object -> partial standpoint -> conditional sentence -> sevenfold expansion.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

2. SAPTABHĀṆGĪNAYA FACT:

2.1 Nayavāda: standpoint-theory

Statement. FACT: *Nayavāda* teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a **naya**, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

Argument. FACT:

1. Reality is many-sided.
2. Finite knowers rarely grasp all sides at once.
3. Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.
4. A doctrine of standpoints is needed to explain how partial truth is possible.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Partiality is not falsehood; it becomes falsehood only when the partial is absolutized.

Distinction. FACT: *Nayavāda* is not skepticism. It permits truth, but qualified truth.

Example. FACT: A jar may be described as clay, as container, as round, as breakable, as existing-now. Each statement is true from a standpoint.

Objection (Nyāya-style objection). FACT: Standpoints may proliferate without limit.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina thinkers classify principal standpoints to discipline rather than dissolve discourse.

2.2 The seven nayas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Classical Jainism enumerates **seven nayas**, each marking a characteristic standpoint.

Naya	Brief meaning
Naigama naya	common or teleological standpoint; mixed, unspecialized practical view

Naya	Brief meaning
Samgraha naya	generic standpoint; emphasis on class-character
Vyavahāra naya	practical or particular standpoint; ordinary usage about specific things
Rjusūtra naya	momentary or present-state standpoint
Śabda naya	verbal standpoint; attention to linguistic expression
Samabhirūḍha naya	etymological or strictly differentiated verbal standpoint
Evambhūta naya	actuality-conditioned verbal standpoint; a term applies when the function is being performed

Argument. FACT: The list shows that partiality may arise from pragmatic, generic, particular, temporal, and linguistic conditioning.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

Distinction. FACT: Do not confuse **nayas** (standpoints) with the **sevenfold predications** of syādvāda. The former are epistemic perspectives; the latter are structured propositional forms.

Example. FACT: Calling a person “a singer” may be true generically or dispositionally, but **evambhūta naya** is stricter: the term applies in the relevant performance-actuality.

Objection (examiner's objection). FACT: The linguistic nayas seem overly scholastic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.

2.3 Syādvāda as logical expression

Statement. FACT: **Syādvāda** is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification **syāt**—“in some respect,” “from a certain standpoint,” or “conditionally.”

Argument. FACT:

1. Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.
2. Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.
3. The particle **syāt** prevents absolutization.
4. Hence syādvāda is the logical-linguistic expression of anekāntavāda.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Good logic mirrors ontological complexity and epistemic modesty.

Distinction. FACT: Anekāntavāda = metaphysical doctrine; nayavāda = theory of standpoints; syādvāda = mode of conditional predication.

Example. FACT: “The jar exists” becomes “syād asti”—it exists in some respect, e.g., as present on the floor now.

Objection (Śaṅkara-style objection). FACT: Constant qualification may weaken assertoric force.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jaina logic accepts that precision is preferable to dogmatic simplicity.

2.4 Saptabhaṅgī: the seven predications, exactly and in order FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **saptabhaṅgī** is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier **syāt**.

1. **syād asti** — in some respect, it is.
2. **syād nāsti** — in some respect, it is not.
3. **syād asti ca nāsti ca** — in some respect, it is and it is not.
4. **syād avaktavyam** — in some respect, it is indescribable.
5. **syād asti ca avaktavyam** — in some respect, it is and is indescribable.
6. **syād nāsti ca avaktavyam** — in some respect, it is not and is indescribable.
7. **syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam** — in some respect, it is, is not, and is indescribable.

Argument. FACT:

1. A thing may be affirmed under one standpoint.
2. Negated under another.
3. Both affirmed and negated under different references or times.
4. Called indescribable where simultaneous exhaustive predication fails.
5. Combinations of these yield seven basic structured forms.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Contraries need not violate logic when they are indexed to standpoint, time, relation, or mode.

Distinction. FACT: “Indescribable” does not mean mystical silence simpliciter. It means that an unqualified or simultaneous statement is not straightforwardly expressible.

Example. FACT: A clay jar exists now on the table; it does not exist as a lump of raw clay; it both is and is not under different modal descriptions; in a complex state of transition it may be called avaktavya.

Objection (Śaṃkara/Rāmānuja objection). FACT: Critics say this violates non-contradiction.

Reply. FACT: The Jaina response is that contradiction would arise only if affirmation and negation were made in the same respect at the same time in the same sense. Syāt blocks that absolutist reading.

2.5 Blind men and the elephant FACT:

Statement. FACT: The familiar illustration of the blind men and the elephant captures the spirit of anekāntavāda: each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.

Argument. ANALYSIS: The illustration dramatizes the difference between **partial correctness** and **exclusive completeness**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

Distinction. FACT: The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is not itself the formal doctrine.

Example. FACT: One touches the trunk and says “the elephant is like a serpent,” another the leg and says “like a pillar.” Each is conditionally right and absolutely wrong.

Objection (pedagogical objection). FACT: The parable may trivialize complex metaphysics.

Reply. ANALYSIS: It is pedagogical, not probative; its use is to clarify the structure of partial truth.

2.6 Five kinds of knowledge FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology commonly speaks of **five kinds of knowledge**: **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Kind of knowledge	Basic sense
Mati-jñāna	sensory-mental cognition, ordinary empirical knowledge
Śruta-jñāna	scriptural/verbal knowledge, mediated through signs and teaching
Avadhi-jñāna	clairvoyant knowledge of material things beyond ordinary sense range
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	telepathic knowledge of mental states
Kevala-jñāna	perfect omniscience

Argument. FACT: The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction from cognition.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul’s purity.

Distinction. FACT: In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of knowledge with the seven nayas or the sevenfold predication.

Example. FACT: The ordinary learner begins with mati and śruta, while the liberated or near-liberated soul culminates in kevala-jñāna.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Higher forms seem unverifiable.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Within Jainism they are internally connected to the ontology of soul and karma; externally they remain open to critical challenge.

2.7 Standard objection: is anekāntavāda self-refuting or trivial? FACT:

Statement. FACT: Critics argue either that anekāntavāda is self-refuting—because the claim that “all reality is many-sided” is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. If every assertion must be qualified, then the doctrine itself must be qualified.
2. If qualified, it may lose universal force.
3. If unqualified, it violates its own rule.
4. Alternatively, if it merely says that things can be looked at in different ways, it seems philosophically thin.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A doctrine of relativity must explain its own status.

Reply. FACT:

1. Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is also expressible from a standpoint.
2. This does not collapse it; it exhibits the very discipline it teaches.
3. The thesis is not that all statements are equally true, but that truth is aspect-conditioned.
4. Its philosophical bite lies in reconciling plurality with realism, not in banal relativism.

2.8 Does Jaina non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022) ANALYSIS:

Statement. ANALYSIS: A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.

Argument of the challenge. FACT:

1. The doctrine claims universal scope.
2. Universal scope appears absolute.
3. Therefore the doctrine seems to rely on the very absolutism it criticizes.

Jaina reply. FACT:

1. Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.
2. The doctrine is a methodological and ontological caution against ekānta, not a ban on all graded comprehensiveness.
3. Within Jainism, **kevala-jñāna** represents total knowledge, while ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound.
4. Hence the charge succeeds only if one confuses finite judgement with omniscient cognition.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: This is a subtle and strong reply: Jainism can admit a difference between omniscience and ordinary language without abandoning its critique of dogmatic partiality.

2.9 Is Jainism pluralistic and realistic? (2025) ANALYSIS:

Statement. ANALYSIS: Yes, Jainism is strongly **pluralistic** and broadly **realistic**, though both labels require nuance.

Why pluralistic. FACT:

1. It accepts many real souls.
2. It accepts multiple irreducible dravyas.
3. It rejects monistic reduction.
4. Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

Why realistic. FACT:

1. It treats dravyas, qualities, and modes as objectively real.
2. The external world is not illusion.
3. Knowledge aims at real objects, though only under standpoints.

Nuance. ANALYSIS: Its realism is **qualified realism**, because judgement is standpoint-indexed. But qualification of knowledge does not imply unreality of the object.

Objection (realist objection). FACT: If all knowledge is relative to standpoint, realism weakens.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism separates ontological realism from epistemic non-absolutism: reality is objective, but our finite access to it is partial.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections and replies

Contradiction: "is" and "is not" cannot both be true. The Jaina reply is that they are never asserted in the same respect, relation, place and time. Qualification preserves rather than violates non-contradiction.

Redundancy: why exactly seven forms? They systematically combine affirmation, negation and inexpressibility without repeating a logical possibility.

Self-refutation: if all claims are conditional, is *anekāntavāda* itself merely conditional? The strongest Jaina reply distinguishes the minimal unconditional insight that finite unqualified predication is incomplete from an exhaustive absolutist description of reality.

The omniscience cost: *kevala-jñāna* prevents the system from becoming total relativism, but its independent proof remains difficult. Thus Jainism is better classified as qualified or non-absolutist realism, not relativism in the sense that every opinion is equally true.

LINK: 2026 conceptual anchor: recent public and educational discussions around Mahāvīra Jayanti again used *anekāntavāda* as a resource for dialogue amid polarization. This is an application analogy only, not evidence for the classical doctrine.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2021, Q7(c), 15 marks: define the doctrinal chain, list all seven predicates in order, apply one jar example, block the contradiction objection, and conclude that this is disciplined conditional predication.

2022, Q6(b), 15 marks: reconstruct the absolutism objection fairly, distinguish non-absolutism from sceptical relativism, use *kevala-jñāna* as the Jaina reply, and concede the residual burden.

2023, Q5(a), 10 marks: qualify the quotation "all human knowledge is empirical and relative" using the fivefold knowledge scheme.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

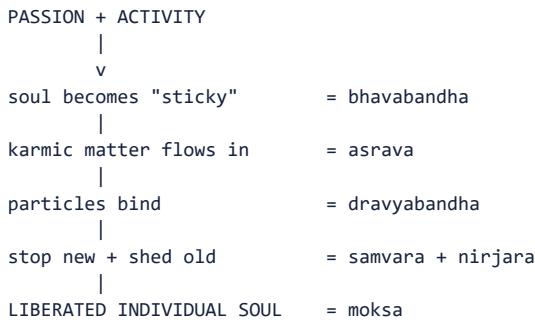
Rapid recall

- Seven *nayas* are standpoint disciplines; seven *bhaṅgas* are predicative forms.
- *Syāt* means "in some respect", not "perhaps" or mere probability.
- Third form asserts is-and-is-not successively or under different qualifications.
- *Avaktavya* marks the limit of one simple utterance, not total unknowability.
- Trap: the blind-men-and-elephant story illustrates partiality, not equality of all opinions.

Progress: 5 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Bondage, Karma, Spiritual Stages and Liberation

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the dust and wet-cloth model



In simple words: anger, pride, deceit and greed create the inner condition for bondage. Subtle karmic matter then attaches to the soul and obscures its natural knowledge. Liberation removes the obstruction; it does not create a new soul.

Core term	Easy meaning
<i>Āsrava</i>	Influx of karmic matter
<i>Bandha</i>	Binding
<i>Samvara</i>	Stopping new influx
<i>Nirjarā</i>	Shedding old karma
<i>Mokṣa</i>	Complete freedom with individuality retained

Memory line: inner passion causes material bondage; restraint stops it and discipline removes it.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

3. BONDAGE AND LIBERATION FACT:

3.1 Karma as subtle material substance

Statement. FACT: Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that **karma is a subtle material substance**, a form of **pudgala** that flows toward and binds the soul.

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul's intrinsic omniscience is obscured in empirical life.
2. This obscuration requires a real binding factor.
3. That factor is karma, conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.
4. Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ethical and cognitive defilement must have a concrete causal structure.

Distinction. FACT: This is a crucial UPSC trap: in Jainism karma is **material**, unlike many Hindu presentations where karma is a moral force, merit-demerit ledger, or *adṛṣṭa*.

Example. FACT: Passions attract karmic particles just as a sticky surface gathers dust.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can matter bind a conscious immaterial soul?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism answers through intimate association and obscuration, though critics often say the mechanism remains conceptually difficult.

3.2 The fivefold soteriological sequence FACT:

Statement. FACT: The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence **āsrava -> bandha -> samvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa**.

Stage	Meaning
Āsrava	influx of karmic matter into the soul
Bandha	bondage; karmic matter adheres to the soul
Samvara	stoppage of fresh inflow
Nirjarā	shedding or exhaustion of accumulated karma
Mokṣa	complete release from karma

Argument. FACT:

1. Wrong belief, passions, and activity open the soul to karmic influx.
2. Influx produces bondage.
3. Discipline blocks new inflow.
4. Austerity and purification burn off old karma.
5. When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Spiritual progress is both preventive and purgative.

Distinction. FACT: Samvara and nirjarā are not the same: one stops new karma; the other removes old karma.

Example. FACT: Closing a muddy stream into a tank is like samvara; cleaning the sediment already deposited is like nirjarā.

Objection (Buddhist/Vedānta-style objection). FACT: The process may seem mechanically moralistic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Its strength is exactly its causal clarity: vice has ontological consequence; discipline has ontological remedy.

3.3 Bhāva-bandha and dravya-bandha (2024) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Bondage has two closely related forms: **bhāva-bandha** (psychic bondage) and **dravya-bandha** (material bondage).

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passions, attachment, aversion, delusion, and wrong disposition.
2. This inner deformation is **bhāva-bandha**.
3. Corresponding karmic particles then attach materially to the soul.
4. This actual material adhesion is **dravya-bandha**.
5. Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Inner states are causally efficacious; moral psychology precedes material karmic accretion.

Distinction. FACT:

- **Bhāva-bandha** = subjective, intentional, affective bondage.
- **Dravya-bandha** = objective, material bondage by karmic pudgala.

Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāva-bandha; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is dravya-bandha.

Objection (analytical objection). FACT: Why not collapse them into one process?

Reply. FACT: The distinction helps Jainism explain both moral agency and ontological consequence: one is the soul's state, the other is the karmic material result.

3.4 The three jewels FACT:

Statement. FACT: Liberation requires the **three jewels (ratnatraya)**: **samyag-darśana** (right faith/vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyag-cāritra** (right conduct).

Argument. FACT:

1. One must first see reality correctly.
2. One must know it correctly.
3. One must live in accordance with that insight.
4. Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop karmic influx.
5. Mere conduct without right view lacks orientation.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.

Distinction. FACT: The three jewels are not sequential in a crude external sense; they are mutually reinforcing dimensions of one path.

Example. FACT: One who knows non-violence conceptually but continues harmful conduct has not completed the path.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Is “faith” here blind belief?

Reply. FACT: No. Samyag-darśana is right apprehension or trustful orientation to truth, not irrational fideism.

3.5 Five mahāvratas FACT:

Statement. FACT: Right conduct is classically articulated through the **five mahāvratas**: **ahiṃsā**, **satya**, **asteya**, **brahmacarya**, and **aparigraha**.

Argument. FACT: These vows reduce passions, prevent harmful activity, and therefore check karmic influx.

Vow	Basic meaning	Soteriological relevance
Ahiṃsā	non-violence	central because injury binds karma deeply
Satya	truthfulness	purifies speech and intention
Asteya	non-stealing	curbs acquisitive harm
Brahmacarya	chastity / control of sensuality	disciplines desire
Aparigraha	non-possession / non-attachment	reduces grasping and karmic adhesion

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Ethical discipline is metaphysically effective, not merely socially good.

Distinction. FACT: In Jainism ahiṃsā is not only a moral ideal but a central soteriological technology.

Example. FACT: Extreme care toward even one-sense beings follows from the pluralistic doctrine of jīva.

Objection (householder-pragmatic objection). FACT: Such rigor seems too severe for ordinary life.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes full vows for ascetics and limited observances for householders, preserving the ideal while allowing graded practice.

3.6 Kevala-jñāna FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Kevala-jñāna** is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

Argument. FACT:

1. The soul is intrinsically omniscient.
2. Ignorance is due to karmic obstruction.
3. Remove the obstruction and the native luminosity manifests completely.
4. Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Perfection is recovery, not production ex nihilo.

Distinction. FACT: Kevala-jñāna differs from scriptural knowledge and extraordinary clairvoyance; it is total, direct, unobstructed knowledge.

Example. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkara is revered as one who attained such perfect knowledge.

Objection (Buddhist/Cārvāka objection). FACT: Omniscience seems excessive or unverifiable.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Within Jaina metaphysics, omniscience is the natural terminus of complete karmic purification.

3.7 Mokṣa FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Mokṣa** is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to **siddha-śīlā**.

Argument. FACT:

1. Bondage is due to karmic accretion.
2. Complete stoppage and exhaustion of karma eliminate bondage.
3. The soul then manifests its intrinsic excellences unobstructed.
4. Being no longer weighed down by karmic matter, it rises to the topmost region of the cosmos.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation is individual and cosmologically locatable within the Jaina universe.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman. Unlike Buddhist nirvāṇa, it is liberation of a distinct enduring jīva.

Example. FACT: The liberated soul is a **siddha**, no longer embodied, no longer karmically entangled.

Objection (modern philosophical objection). FACT: Spatial ascent of a liberated soul may seem mythic.

Reply. ANALYSIS: In doctrinal exposition, one should report the cosmological picture faithfully while separating canonical doctrine from modern philosophical evaluation.

3A. SEVEN TATTVAS AND NINE PADĀRTHAS FACT:

3A.1 Seven tattvas FACT:

Statement. FACT: The seven **tattvas** (real categories for liberation-analysis) are **jīva**, **ajīva**, **āsrava**, **bandha**, **saṃvara**, **nirjarā**, and **mokṣa**.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Jīva** and **ajīva** identify the two broad ontological poles.
2. FACT: **Āsrava** explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.
3. FACT: **Bandha** explains how that matter becomes bound.
4. FACT: **Saṃvara** explains the stopping of new influx.
5. FACT: **Nirjarā** explains the shedding or wearing away of accumulated karma.
6. FACT: **Mokṣa** names the final state when all karmic bondage is absent.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Metaphysics is organized around soteriology: the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.

Distinction. FACT: The tattva-list moves from what exists to what binds and what liberates.

Example. FACT: A person's anger is not merely a mental event; it opens āsrava, deepens bandha, and must be countered by saṃvara and nirjarā.

Objection (Buddhist-style objection). FACT: The list seems to reify a permanent soul and material karma beyond observable process.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that without jīva and karma-pudgala, bondage and liberation cannot be explained as real transformation of an enduring knower.

3A.2 Nine padārthas FACT:

Statement. FACT: The nine **padārthas** are the same seven tattvas plus **puṇya** (merit) and **pāpa** (demerit).

Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Seven tattvas	FACT: jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā, mokṣa	FACT: Standard liberation-sequence framework

Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Nine padārthas	FACT: the seven plus puṇya and pāpa	FACT: Makes moral valence explicit

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Puṇya and pāpa are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect karmic bondage.
2. ANALYSIS: They can also be subsumed under āsrava and bandha because both merit and demerit are forms of karmic involvement.
3. ANALYSIS: Hence some expositions emphasize seven for soteriological mechanics and nine for moral classification.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Even “good” karma remains karmic bondage if it keeps the soul within saṃsāra.

Distinction. FACT: Puṇya is better than pāpa ethically, but both are to be transcended for mokṣa.

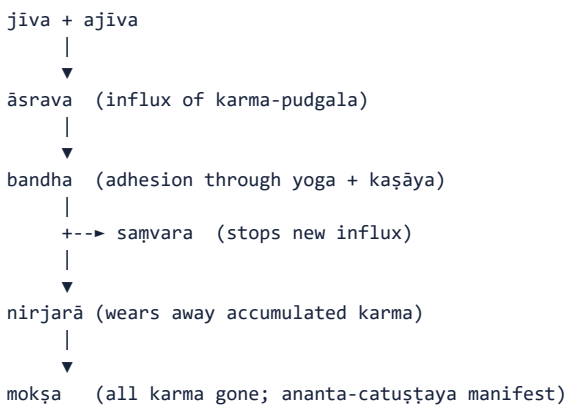
Example. FACT: Charity performed with attachment may produce puṇya, but liberation requires non-attachment rather than pleasant rebirth alone.

Objection (Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: If puṇya is morally valuable, why treat it as ultimately part of bondage?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes ethical improvement within saṃsāra from final release beyond all karmic determination.

3A.3 Soteriological flow: liberation by subtraction FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul’s **ananta-catuṣṭaya** (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.



Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The soul does not manufacture omniscience from nothing.
2. FACT: It removes what obscures its intrinsic cognitive and blissful capacity.
3. FACT: Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.
4. FACT: Mokṣa is the purified manifestation of what the jīva essentially is.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The self is intrinsically capable of perfection, but empirically veiled by beginningless karma.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina mokṣa is not acquisition of God’s grace, not merger into Brahman, and not annihilation of self; it is release of an individual jīva from karmic matter.

Example. FACT: Cleaning a sooted lamp does not create light; it allows light to shine unobstructed.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is intrinsically omniscient, why was it obscured at all?

Reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but purification can terminate the bondage.

3B. EIGHT KARMA-PRAKṚTIS AND THE MECHANICS OF BANDHA FACT:

3B.1 Karma is material pudgala FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: **karma-pudgala** is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Empirical ignorance, delusion, embodied limitation, status, pleasure-pain, and lifespan require causal explanation.
2. FACT: Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.
3. FACT: **Bhāva-karma** (the soul's psychical state) attracts **dravya-karma** (material karmic influx).
4. FACT: Thus passions and activities have ontological consequences, not merely psychological consequences.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Moral causation is not merely legal or symbolic; it is a real interaction between a modified soul and subtle matter.

Distinction. FACT: This differs sharply from Nyāya **adr̥ṣṭa**, Mīmāṃsā **apūrvā**, Sāṃkhya **saṃskāra**, and Buddhist **vāsanā**, which are not material karmic particles.

Example. FACT: Anger makes the soul "sticky," as oil or wet clay gathers dust; the image expresses the causal role of kaṣāya.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can material karma bind an immaterial conscious soul?

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that the embodied jīva is not absolutely non-spatial: it has **pradeśas**, is co-extensive with the body, and is modified by bhāva-karma; karmic matter is attracted through passions. ANALYSIS: A residual difficulty remains because interaction between consciousness and matter still demands explanation.

3B.2 Eight basic karma-prakṛtis FACT:

Class	Karma-prakṛti	What it obscures or determines	Philosophical significance
Ghātiyā	FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya	knowledge	FACT: Blocks the soul's intrinsic knowing
Ghātiyā	FACT: Darśanāvaraṇīya	perception or apprehension	FACT: Blocks direct awareness
Ghātiyā	FACT: Mohanīya	right vision and conduct	FACT: Most dangerous because delusion misorients the path
Ghātiyā	FACT: Antarāya	energy, power, capacity to act	FACT: Obstructs the soul's effective power
Aghātiyā	FACT: Vedanīya	pleasure and pain	FACT: Determines felt experience without destroying essence
Aghātiyā	FACT: Nāma	body, form, embodiment	FACT: Determines the type of body and individuality of embodiment
Aghātiyā	FACT: Gotra	status or family-standing	FACT: Determines high or low status conditions
Aghātiyā	FACT: Āyus	lifespan	FACT: Determines duration of embodied life

Statement. FACT: The eight karmas divide into **ghātiyā** karmas, which damage or obscure the soul's essential qualities, and **aghātiyā** karmas, which determine embodiment without directly destroying those qualities.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya, and antarāya are ghātiyā because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation, and power.
2. FACT: Vedanīya, nāma, gotra, and āyus are aghātiyā because they structure embodied experience, body, status, and lifespan.
3. FACT: **Mohanīya** is the most dangerous because delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct.
4. FACT: Mohanīya is commonly divided into **darśana-mohanīya** and **cāritra-mohanīya**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation requires not only moral improvement but precise removal of the karmic veils that obstruct the soul's essential nature.

Distinction. FACT: The arhat at the **sayoga-kevalī** stage has destroyed ghātiyā karmas but still lives with remaining aghātiyā karmas until final release.

Example. FACT: A kevalin has omniscience because knowledge-obscuring karma is destroyed, but embodied life continues until lifespan-determining karma is exhausted.

Objection (Buddhist objection). FACT: The taxonomy seems metaphysically heavy compared with a mental-volitional account of karma.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism accepts the heaviness because it wants a realist explanation of why cognition, embodiment, status, pleasure, and lifespan are all karmically structured.

3B.3 Four parameters of bandha FACT:

Statement. FACT: Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: **prakṛti** (type or nature), **sthiti** (duration), **anubhāga** or **rasa** (intensity), and **pradeśa** (quantity of karmic matter).

Bandha-parameter	Meaning	Main determinant
Prakṛti	FACT: type of karma bound	FACT: Yoga (activity of body, speech, and mind)
Sthiti	FACT: duration of bondage	FACT: Kaṣāya (passions)
Anubhāga / rasa	FACT: intensity or fruition-strength	FACT: Kaṣāya
Pradeśa	FACT: quantity of karmic matter bound	FACT: Yoga

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Yoga** brings karmic matter into relation with the soul and determines type and quantity.
2. FACT: **Kaṣāya** makes the bondage deep, long-lasting, and intense.
3. FACT: Activity without passion therefore has a radically different karmic effect from activity with passion.
4. FACT: This explains the contrast between **īryāpathika bandha** (momentary bondage from activity without passion) and **sāmparāyika bandha** (durable bondage from passion-coloured activity).

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment, and delusion.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is not crude physicalism: material karma binds through psychical states; passion is doctrinally decisive.

Example. FACT: A monk's careful walking may involve bodily activity, but if free from passion it binds only momentarily; an angry act binds deeply because kaṣāya fixes the karma.

Objection (Mīmāṃsā-Nyāya objection). FACT: This mechanism seems more elaborate than needed to explain moral consequence.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that the elaboration is the point: it explains why intention, passion, duration, intensity, and embodiment are linked in a single karmic science.

3C. FOURTEEN GUṆASTHĀNAS: STAGES OF SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT FACT:

3C.1 Ordered list FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **guṇasthānas** are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

No.	Guṇasthāna	Brief gloss
1	FACT: Mithyā-dṛṣṭi	false vision; complete wrong orientation
2	FACT: Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna	falling condition with a lingering taste of right vision

No.	Guṇasthāna	Brief gloss
3	FACT: Miśra / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi	mixed right and wrong orientation
4	FACT: Avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi	right vision without full restraint
5	FACT: Deśavirata	partial restraint, especially lay vows
6	FACT: Pramatta-saṃyata	full restraint with negligence
7	FACT: Apramatta-saṃyata	full restraint without negligence
8	FACT: Apūrva-karaṇa / nivṛtti-bādara	unprecedented purification; gross passions being transformed
9	FACT: Anivṛtti-bādara	further advanced purification of gross passions
10	FACT: Sūkṣma-samparāya	only subtle greed remains
11	FACT: Upaśānta-moha	delusion suppressed, not destroyed
12	FACT: Kṣīṇa-moha	delusion destroyed
13	FACT: Sayoga-kevalī	omniscient embodied arhat with activity still present
14	FACT: Ayoga-kevalī	activity ceases; momentary final state before siddhatva

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: The first three stages describe wrong, falling, or mixed vision.
2. FACT: Stage 4 is decisive because **samyag-darśana** first becomes stable enough to orient the path.
3. FACT: Stages 5–7 discipline conduct through partial and full restraint.
4. FACT: Stages 8–10 refine passions from gross to extremely subtle.
5. FACT: Stages 11–12 mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion.
6. FACT: Stages 13–14 explain how omniscience and final disembodiment are related.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Liberation is gradual, psychologically exact, and karmically measurable.

Distinction. FACT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet complete ascetic conduct.

Example. FACT: A layperson with right vision and partial vows belongs doctrinally closer to stage 5 than to complete monastic purification.

Objection (Advaita-style objection). FACT: A fourteen-stage ladder may seem to turn liberation into a mechanical sequence rather than insight.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism replies that insight, conduct, and karmic purification must be integrated; right vision without progressive destruction of karma is incomplete.

3C.2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina doctrine distinguishes **upaśama-śreṇi** (ladder of suppression) and **kṣapaka-śreṇi** (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: **Upaśama-śreṇi** suppresses delusion and can reach stage 11.
2. FACT: Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.
3. FACT: **Kṣapaka-śreṇi** destroys delusion and reaches stage 12 and beyond.
4. FACT: At stage 13 the **sayoga-kevalī** has kevala-jñāna but still retains embodied activity because aghātiyā karmas remain.
5. FACT: Stage 14, **ayoga-kevalī**, is the momentary cessation of activity immediately before **siddhatva**.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Suppression is spiritually unstable; destruction alone is final.

Distinction. FACT: The sayoga-kevalī is the Jaina answer to “is jīvanmukti possible?”: the embodied omniscient arhat is liberated-in-life in the Jaina sense, though final siddha-state follows only after remaining aghātiyā karmas are exhausted.

Example. FACT: A lamp with its obscuring cover removed shines fully even before the lamp is relocated; similarly the arhat is omniscient while embodied.

Objection (Rāmānuja-style objection). FACT: Omniscience while embodied may seem unintelligible if embodiment itself implies limitation.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism distinguishes ghātiyā karmas, which obstruct essential knowledge, from aghātiyā karmas, which sustain embodiment without blocking omniscience.

3D. SALLEKHANĀ / SANTHĀRĀ: DEATH WITHOUT PASSION FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Sallekhanā** or **santhārā** is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

Argument. FACT:

1. FACT: Bondage tracks **kaṣāya**: passion fixes karmic matter more deeply than bare activity.
2. FACT: A death faced with equanimity minimizes new influx and prevents panic, attachment, and aversion from creating fresh bondage.
3. FACT: The aim is not to end life as such but to end passion at the moment when life is already naturally or medically approaching its close.
4. FACT: The practice must be free from desire for death, desire to continue living, attachment to friends, recollection of pleasures, and hope of reward.
5. FACT: If such motives enter, the act becomes an **aticāra** (transgression) of the vow’s proper discipline.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: The karmic quality of dying depends on the inner state with which death is faced.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes **sallekhanā** from **ātma-ghāta** (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; **sallekhanā** is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

Example. FACT: An elderly ascetic or lay practitioner facing irreversible decline may gradually reduce intake under religious supervision while cultivating forgiveness, detachment, and equanimity.

Objection (modern legal-ethical objection). CAUTION: Critics in India have disputed whether **sallekhanā** is protected religious practice or an impermissible form of self-destruction.

Reply. ANALYSIS: The Jaina reply is that legal and ethical evaluation must distinguish intention, procedure, publicity, non-violence, and the absence of death-desire; the controversy is a useful Paper II bridge to religion and morality, but specific case names, holdings, dates, and statutory details should not be asserted unless separately verified.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced objections, replies and ethical refinements

The distinctive strength of Jaina karma theory is its integration of psychology, ethics and embodiment: *bhāvabandha* explains inner adhesiveness, while *dravyabandha* explains objective karmic continuity. Its deepest metaphysical weakness is interaction: how does material *pudgala* bind an intrinsically conscious soul?

Beginningless bondage avoids the need for a first moral fall, but creates another question: if the soul is naturally perfect, why is obscuration beginningless? Jainism answers operationally rather than historically—liberation requires removing present causes and accumulated matter.

The fourteen *guṇasthānas* make liberation gradual and technically ordered. The *sayoga-kevalī* stage is important because omniscience can occur while minimal embodied activity remains; final disembodied liberation follows later.

Sallekhanā must be analysed by intention, conditions and passionlessness. In its ideal doctrinal form it is a disciplined thinning of attachment at life’s appropriate end, not impulsive self-destruction. Contemporary legal or medical claims

require separate case-specific verification.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

2018, Q6(c), 15 marks: define bondage, distinguish bound and liberated souls, explain *bhāvabandha/dravyabandha*, and state the liberated condition.

2020, Q5(a), 10 marks and **2022, Q5(d), 10 marks:** focus on the bearing of material karma on liberation through *āsrava-bandha-saṃvara-nirjarā-mokṣa*.

2024, Q6(c), 15 marks: make the psychic/material distinction causal, not merely definitional, and add the four parameters of material bondage.

Use the three jewels and vows as mechanisms of *saṃvara* and *nirjarā*, not as an ornamental ethical list.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Karma is subtle material *pudgala*, not merely moral memory.
- Four *kaṣāyas*: anger, pride, deceit and greed.
- Seven *tattvas*; nine *padārthas* add merit and demerit.
- Eight karma-types divide into four destructive and four non-destructive classes.
- Four bandha parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.
- Liberation reveals intrinsic knowledge and bliss; individual *siddhas* do not merge.

Progress: 6 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Inter-School Debates and the Strongest Criticism-Reply Grid

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - what each rival attacks

BUDDHISM -> Why posit a permanent soul?
ADVAITA -> How can opposites be finally real?
NYAYA -> How does soul expand with the body?
CARVAKA -> Where is evidence for karma and omniscience?
JAINA REPLY -> each criticism absolutises one dimension

In simple words: rival schools attack different joints of the Jaina system. A good answer must name the target accurately before giving the Jaina reply.

Rival	Main pressure point
Buddhism	Permanence amid change
Advaita	Real plurality and opposed predicates
Nyāya	Soul-body extension and material karma
Cārvāka	Unverifiable soul, karma and omniscience

Memory line: state the critic's criterion first; then show what the Jaina distinction saves and what burden remains.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

4. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES ANALYSIS:

4.1 Jainism vs Buddhism on reality

Axis	Jainism	Buddhism
Self	Many enduring jīvas	Anātman / no enduring self-substance
Reality	Substance with permanence-in-change	Strong tendency to momentariness in many schools
Logic of judgement	Conditional many-sided predication	Often sharper critiques of substantial identity
Karma	Material karmic accretion	Moral-causal continuity without material karmic particles
Liberation	Distinct soul freed from karma	Nirvāṇa without eternal self

4.2 Jainism vs Advaita Vedānta

Axis	Jainism	Advaita
Ultimate reality	Pluralistic	Non-dual Brahman
World	Real	Empirically real, ultimately dependent / mithyā
Souls	Many real jīvas	Ultimately one ātman/Brahman
Ignorance/bondage	Karmic material obscuration	Avidyā / adhyāsa
Liberation	Distinct siddhas	Realization of non-duality

4.3 Jainism vs Cārvāka

Axis	Jainism	Cārvāka
Ontology	Pluralist realism with soul and karma	Materialist minimalism
Karma	Material and real	Rejected
Liberation	Central	Denied or emptied
Logic	Conditional predication	Suspicion of inference and testimony
Ethics	Austerity and ahiṃsā	This-worldly pleasure and prudence

5. NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAINA REPLIES FACT:

5.1 Śaṃkara's critique of anekāntavāda FACT:

Statement. FACT: Śaṃkara, in the *Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya*, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.
2. FACT: If everything is "somehow yes and somehow no," practical action loses clear guidance.
3. FACT: If anekāntavāda asserts itself absolutely, it contradicts itself.
4. FACT: If it asserts itself only conditionally, it seems to lose universal force.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A viable metaphysics must preserve non-contradiction and assertoric clarity.

Jaina reply. FACT:

1. FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: **dravya** (substance), **kṣetra** (place), **kāla** (time), and **bhāva** (mode).

2. **FACT:** There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode.
3. **FACT:** Syādvāda is itself asserted **syāt**; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule.
4. **ANALYSIS:** A residual objection remains: if syādvāda is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

5.2 Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes **FACT:**

Statement. **FACT:** Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

Argument of the critic. **FACT:**

1. **FACT:** A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.
2. **FACT:** If the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent.
3. **FACT:** If they are not real, Jaina realism weakens.

Presupposition. **ANALYSIS:** Real predication must avoid contradiction at the level of the object, not merely at the level of language.

Jaina reply. **FACT:** The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same dravya persists while paryāyas arise and cease, so the opposition is between aspects, not within one unqualified predication.

Assessment. **ANALYSIS:** The reply works best if one accepts the dravya–paryāya distinction; it is less persuasive to schools that reject such aspect-realism.

5.3 Dharmakīrti / Buddhist critique of permanent-yet-changing soul **FACT:**

Statement. **FACT:** A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.

Argument of the critic. **FACT:**

1. **FACT:** If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.
2. **FACT:** What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.
3. **FACT:** A permanent entity that changes faces the **arthakriyā** (causal efficacy) dilemma: if it acts, it changes; if it does not change, it cannot act.

Presupposition. **ANALYSIS:** Causal efficacy and permanence are difficult to combine in one substance.

Jaina reply. **FACT:** Jainism replies through **utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya**: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

Assessment. **ANALYSIS:** The Buddhist objection remains strong if one denies the real distinction between substance and modes.

5.4 Nyāya critique of the soul's expansion and material karma **FACT:**

Statement. **FACT:** Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

Argument of the critic. **FACT:**

1. **FACT:** An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.
2. **FACT:** If the self has parts or pradeśas, its eternality seems threatened.
3. **FACT:** Material karma is less parsimonious than an unseen moral potency such as adṛṣṭa.

Presupposition. **ANALYSIS:** A permanent self should be partless or at least not spatially variable.

Jaina reply. **FACT:** Jainism invokes **pradeśas** and the lamp simile: consciousness can pervade the body without being identical with gross matter, and karmic pudgala explains concrete embodiment better than a merely invisible potency.

Assessment. **ANALYSIS:** The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the interaction of conscious pradeśa-bearing jīva and matter remains a debated point.

5.5 Sāṃkhya/Vedānta critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage FACT:

Statement. FACT: Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul and what began the obscuration.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

1. FACT: If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.
2. FACT: If karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.
3. FACT: If karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: A theory of bondage must explain both its origin and its removal.

Jaina reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but disciplined saṃvara and nirjarā can terminate the relation.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply blocks a first-cause demand but leaves a metaphysical puzzle about why beginningless bondage is possible for an intrinsically perfect soul.

5.6 Cārvāka / empiricist critique of omniscience and liberation FACT:

Statement. FACT: A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śilā as unverifiable.

Argument of the critic. FACT: Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

Presupposition. ANALYSIS: Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

Jaina reply. ANALYSIS: Jainism combines testimony, inference, moral phenomenology, and the internal logic of purification to defend these doctrines, but it cannot satisfy a strict materialist who admits only gross perception.

Assessment. ANALYSIS: Use this objection only as an external critique; do not let it replace the named classical objections above.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced dialectical verdict

Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja press the law of non-contradiction: a real cannot possess opposed attributes. The Jaina reply succeeds where predicates are explicitly indexed, but it still must explain the universal status of its own many-sided ontology.

Buddhist criticism challenges the permanent-yet-changing soul. Jainism gains moral agency and numerical continuity, while Buddhism gains ontological economy. Neither side wins without choosing a criterion—continuity, parsimony or explanatory adequacy.

Nyāya's interaction and extension objections expose a genuine pressure point. The lamp-light analogy makes bodily co-extension intelligible, but does not fully explain material karma's contact with consciousness.

Cārvāka's evidential challenge is strongest against higher cognition and liberation. Jaina internal coherence is not by itself external verification. The defensible final classification is **pluralistic, realistic and non-absolutist**, with acknowledged burdens concerning omniscience, soul-matter interaction and reflexive qualification.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

Use a four-column dialectic: **critic -> exact objection -> Jaina distinction/reply -> residual problem.**

For "critically discuss", exposition must come before criticism. For comparison, select named axes rather than writing two isolated summaries. The **2025 pluralism and realism** PYQ is the best place to integrate Buddhist, Advaita, Nyāya and Cārvāka pressure.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Criticism is strongest when its criterion is named.
- Indexed opposites answer contradiction better than the slogan "all views are true".
- Permanent substance explains continuity but increases ontological commitment.
- Material karma integrates ethics and embodiment but creates an interaction problem.
- Omniscience blocks total relativism but needs independent support.

Progress: 7 / 7 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: UPSC Synthesis, PYQ Routing and Answer Architecture

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the complete answer spine

DEFINE THE AXIS
|
RECONSTRUCT JAINA DOCTRINE
|
SHOW THE INTERNAL LINK
reality -> judgement -> conduct -> liberation
|
ADD NAMED OBJECTION + BEST REPLY
|
GIVE A QUALIFIED VERDICT

In simple words: a Jaina answer scores when it shows relationships. Do not merely list six substances, seven predicates or five stages; explain why each structure follows from the larger system.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Definition -> core mechanism -> distinction -> verdict
15	Doctrine -> structure/example -> criticism/reply -> assessment
20	Full derivation -> comparison -> dialectic -> criterion-based conclusion

Memory line: many-sided reality requires qualified judgement; purified judgement and conduct remove bondage.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

6. COMMON UPSC TRAPS FACT:

1. **Anekāntavāda ≠ syādvāda ≠ saptabhaṅgī.** FACT: Metaphysics / epistemic-logical method / formal sevenfold predication.
2. **Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala).** FACT: Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.
3. **Six dravyas, but only five astikāyas.** FACT: Kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya; the pañcāstikāya list has five members while the dravya list has six.
4. **Jainism rejects God as creator but not spiritual excellence.** FACT: Liberated souls and Tīrthaṅkaras are worthy of reverence, but there is no creator-God.
5. **Bhāvabandha ≠ dravyabandha.** FACT: Psychic bondage is not identical with material karmic bondage, though they are linked.
6. **Dharma / adharma in ontology do not mean moral merit / sin.** FACT: They are media of motion and rest.
7. **Seven nayas are not the same as seven bhangas.** FACT: One is standpoint taxonomy; the other is predication schema.
8. **Jainism is realist despite epistemic relativity.** ANALYSIS: Partial knowledge does not imply unreal objects.
9. **Jaina pratyakṣa is inverted.** FACT: Strict pratyakṣa is soul-direct knowledge; ordinary sense-perception is only sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa.

10. **Puṇya is not mokṣa.** FACT: Merit may improve saṃsāric condition but still belongs to karmic involvement.
11. **Ghātiyā ≠ aghātiyā karma.** FACT: Ghātiyā karmas obstruct essential qualities; aghātiyā karmas determine embodiment.
12. **Sayoga-kevalī = Jaina jīvanmukta.** FACT: Omniscience can occur while embodied because aghātiyā karmas remain until final siddhatva.

7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK FACT:

- **Anekāntavāda** — doctrine of many-sided reality. FACT:
- **Sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya** — reality involves origination, decay, and permanence. FACT:
- **Dravya-guṇa-paryāya** — substance, qualities, modes. FACT:
- **Jīva / ajīva** — conscious and non-conscious reals. FACT:
- **Syādvāda** — conditional predication. FACT:
- **Saptabhaṅgī** — sevenfold judgement-schema. FACT:
- **Bhāvabandha / dravyabandha** — psychic and material bondage. FACT:
- **Ratnatraya** — right faith, right knowledge, right conduct. FACT:
- **Kevala-jñāna** — omniscience of the purified soul. FACT:
- **Siddha-śīlā** — topmost locus of liberated souls. FACT:
- **Exam sentence:** “Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints.” ANALYSIS:
- **Exam sentence:** “The originality of Jaina soteriology lies in treating karma not merely as moral record but as subtle material bondage requiring both stoppage and shedding.” ANALYSIS:

<!-- restored-2018-2020-doctrine:start -->

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Bound and liberated soul

- FACT: **Bondage:** karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.
- FACT: **Liberation sequence:** saṃvara stops new influx; nirjarā sheds accumulated karma; the purified jīva rises to the siddha-śīlā and remains an individual perfected soul.
- ANALYSIS: **Distinction:** the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.
- CAUTION: **Objection -> reply:** material karma interacting with an immaterial conscious jīva appears category-confused. Jainism treats karmic matter as subtle and invokes the jīva's embodied expansion/contraction, though the mechanism remains contestable.

<!-- restored-2018-2020-doctrine:end -->

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:start -->

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored papers require the mechanics of bondage, bound versus liberated soul, the condition of the siddha, and karma's direct bearing on liberation.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:end -->

7A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Anekāntavāda	ANALYSIS: Reality has many real aspects, not merely many subjective descriptions	ANALYSIS: Jaina non-absolutism becomes either skepticism or loose tolerance
Nayavāda	ANALYSIS: Finite cognition grasps objects through partial standpoints	ANALYSIS: Partial truths become either falsehoods or dogmatic absolutes
Syādvāda / saptabhaṅgī	ANALYSIS: Language must register standpoint, time, place, substance, and mode	ANALYSIS: Conditional predication looks like contradiction or indecision
Dravya as utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya	ANALYSIS: Permanence and change are both objectively real in different respects	ANALYSIS: Jainism collapses either into Buddhist flux or static monism
Five/six substances and astikāya	ANALYSIS: Substance and spatial extension must be distinguished	ANALYSIS: Kāla is confused with the five astikāyas, and pluralist cosmology loses precision
Material karma	ANALYSIS: Moral-psychical states can attract subtle matter	ANALYSIS: Bondage becomes metaphorical and Jaina soteriology loses its distinctive mechanism
Guṇasthāna progression	ANALYSIS: Spiritual development is gradual and karmically measurable	ANALYSIS: Liberation becomes abrupt insight without Jaina moral psychology
Kevala-jñāna	ANALYSIS: The soul's infinite knowledge is intrinsic but obscured	ANALYSIS: Mokṣa becomes acquisition rather than revelation through removal
Ahiṃsā	ANALYSIS: All living jīvas are morally significant and injury binds karma	ANALYSIS: Jaina ethics loses its metaphysical foundation

7B. PŪRVAPAKṢA–SIDDHĀNTA LEDGER FACT:

Objector (named)	Objection	Jaina reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
Śaṃkara	FACT: Anekāntavāda allows contradiction and cannot assert itself consistently	FACT: Predicates are indexed to dravya, kṣetra, kāla, and bhāva; syādvāda is itself asserted syāt	ANALYSIS: Reflexively qualified doctrine may seem to lose assertoric force
Rāmānuja	FACT: A real substance with opposed real attributes is unintelligible	FACT: Opposed predicates belong to different aspects of dravya and paryāya	ANALYSIS: Reply depends on accepting aspect-realism
Dharmakīrti / Buddhist	FACT: Permanent yet changing soul fails the arthakriyā test	FACT: Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya: permanence as dravya, change as paryāya	ANALYSIS: Strong if substance-mode distinction is denied
Nyāya	FACT: Soul's expansion/contraction and material karma are unparsimonious	FACT: Jīva has pradeśas and pervades the body like a lamp; karma-pudgala explains embodiment	ANALYSIS: Consciousness-matter interaction remains difficult
Sāṃkhya/Vedānta	FACT: Intrinsic omniscience plus beginningless obscuration seems puzzling	FACT: Jīva-karma relation is anādi but terminable through saṃvara and nirjarā	ANALYSIS: No first-origin explanation is offered
Cārvāka / empiricist	FACT: Soul, karma-pudgala, omniscience, and siddha-śilā are not perceptually verified	ANALYSIS: Jainism uses inference, testimony, and systematic soteriology	ANALYSIS: Unpersuasive to strict perception-only materialism

7C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING FACT:

School	Pramāṇas admitted	Self	Permanence vs change	Universals	Causation	Creator God	Liberation
Jainism	FACT: Pratyakṣa and parokṣa; developed accounts include anumāna, śabda, smṛti, pratyabhijñā, tarka	FACT: Many permanent jīvas	FACT: Dravya permanent, paryāya changing	ANALYSIS: Real features grasped under standpoints	FACT: Sadasat kāryavāda : effect exists in one respect in the cause because dravya persists, and does not exist in another because paryāya is new	FACT: Anīśvaravāda : no creator; Tīrthaṅkaras are liberated teachers	FACT: Individual siddha freed from all karma
Buddhism	ANALYSIS: Usually perception and inference in classical epistemology	FACT: No permanent ātman	FACT: Momentariness in many schools	ANALYSIS: Often nominal or conceptual	ANALYSIS: Dependent origination, no permanent substrate	FACT: No creator God	FACT: Nirvāṇa without eternal soul-substance
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Perception, inference, comparison, testimony	FACT: Many eternal selves	FACT: Substances endure; qualities change	FACT: Universals real	FACT: Asatkāryavāda; effect newly produced	FACT: Theistic in later Nyāya	FACT: Self freed from suffering, not Jaina omniscient bliss
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	FACT: Perception, inference, reliable testimony	FACT: Many puruṣas	FACT: Puruṣa changeless; prakṛti evolves	ANALYSIS: Not central like Nyāya universals	FACT: Satkāryavāda; effect pre-exists in cause	FACT: Classical Sāṃkhya non-theistic; Yoga admits Īśvara specially	FACT: Kaivalya of puruṣa from prakṛti
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: Multiple pramāṇas including śabda; exact list varies by sub-school	FACT: Enduring self	FACT: World and Veda treated as real	FACT: Realist tendencies	ANALYSIS: Apūrva links ritual action and result	FACT: No creator required for Vedic authority	ANALYSIS: Often cessation of pain / ritual-moral fulfilment depending on account
Advaita	FACT: Six pramāṇas in standard Advaita pedagogy	FACT: Ultimately one ātman-Brahman	FACT: Brahman changeless; world mithyā	ANALYSIS: Ultimately sublated in non-duality	ANALYSIS: Vivarta-style appearance rather than real transformation	ANALYSIS: Īśvara is empirical-soteriological, not ultimate second reality	FACT: Realization of non-duality
Cārvāka	FACT: Perception primarily	FACT: Body-based consciousness	FACT: Material change only	CAUTION: Universals not central as real entities	ANALYSIS: Material causal regularity	FACT: Rejects creator God	FACT: Rejects mokṣa or reduces goal to this-worldly life

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. FACT: Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. FACT: Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. FACT: Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. ANALYSIS: Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

7D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON ANALYSIS:

Western comparison	Point of contact	Disanalogy
Anekāntavāda and Nietzschean perspectivism	ANALYSIS: Both deny a simple “view from nowhere” for ordinary knowers	FACT: Jainism is realist: aspects are in the object; perspectivism is often read anti-realist
Syādvāda and many-valued / paraconsistent logic	ANALYSIS: Seven bhaṅgas resemble non-classical evaluation	FACT: Syāt is a standpoint-operator, not a third truth-value; avaktavya is inexpressibility in one unqualified utterance, not a truth-value gap
Anekānta and Hegelian dialectic	ANALYSIS: Both allow opposites within the real	FACT: Hegelian opposites are sublated into higher synthesis; Jaina aspects coexist without sublation
Ahiṃsā and Schweitzer’s reverence for life	ANALYSIS: Both widen moral concern toward life	FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is grounded in jīva, karma, and liberation, not only ethical reverence
Jaina souls and Leibnizian monads	ANALYSIS: Both are plural centres carrying their own history	FACT: Jaina souls interact with karmic matter and vary in spatial extension; monads do not interact materially in the same way
Material karma and mechanistic psychology	ANALYSIS: Both seek causal explanation for conduct and character	FACT: Jaina karma is subtle moral matter tied to liberation, not value-neutral brain mechanism

Rubric. ANALYSIS: Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

7E. DIRECTIVE DECODER ANALYSIS:

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Jainism answer	Closing verdict
Discuss	FACT: Breadth plus coherence	Define doctrine -> explain mechanics -> add one debate	ANALYSIS: "Thus Jainism offers a coherent pluralist realism, though its metaphysical costs remain."
Examine	FACT: Doctrinal accuracy	Break into components: dravya, naya, syāt, karma, mokṣa	ANALYSIS: "The doctrine is intelligible when its presuppositions are made explicit."
Critically examine	FACT: Doctrine plus objections	Present Śaṃkara/Nyāya/Buddhist objections and Jaina replies	ANALYSIS: "The reply is strong internally but not neutral across all schools."
Analyse	FACT: Internal logic	Show cause-effect links: metaphysics -> epistemology -> language -> liberation	ANALYSIS: "Its strength lies in systematic interconnection."
Evaluate	FACT: Balanced judgement	State strengths, weaknesses, and residual contestation	ANALYSIS: "Persuasive as qualified realism; vulnerable on material karma and omniscience."
Compare	FACT: Inter-school positioning	Use axes: self, causation, pramāṇa, karma, mokṣa	ANALYSIS: "The comparison shows Jainism as a middle path between flux and static permanence."
Distinguish	FACT: Conceptual precision	Use tables: anekānta/syādvāda/saptabhaṅgī; bhāva/dravya bandha	ANALYSIS: "The distinction prevents common UPSC connotations."
Elucidate	FACT: Clear explanation with examples	Define -> give example -> link to soteriology	ANALYSIS: "The example reveals the doctrinal logic, not merely illustration."
Comment	FACT: Short evaluative insight	State thesis and one philosophical implication	ANALYSIS: "The comment should be pointed, not a full survey."
Bring out	FACT: Hidden relation	Show how reality is reflected in judgement or karma in liberation	ANALYSIS: "The relation is constitutive, not accidental."
Do you agree?	FACT: Reasoned stance	Agree partly -> give doctrine -> objections -> qualified verdict	ANALYSIS: "Agree within Jaina presuppositions; qualify from rival standpoints."

7F. GRADED VERDICT ON JAINISM ANALYSIS:

Strong FACT:

1. FACT: Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.
2. FACT: Anekāntavāda, nayavāda, and syādvāda form a disciplined sequence from ontology to epistemology to language.
3. FACT: Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.
4. FACT: Its ahimsā follows directly from plural jīvas and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

Weak ANALYSIS:

1. ANALYSIS: Material karma binding a conscious soul remains difficult for non-Jaina metaphysics.
2. ANALYSIS: Omniscience and higher direct knowledges are hard to verify externally.
3. ANALYSIS: The system can seem over-taxonomic in karma-types, guṇasthānas, and nayas.
4. ANALYSIS: Reflexively qualified syādvāda may appear to weaken its own universal claim.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

1. CAUTION: Sectarian nuances about kāla's substantial independence differ in presentation.
2. CAUTION: Modern legal-ethical evaluation of sallekhanā requires case-specific verification before citing details.

3. CAUTION: Historical dating of several Jaina thinkers should not be asserted unless separately verified.

Ready verdicts. ANALYSIS:

- **10 marks:** Jainism is a pluralistic realism that avoids both pure permanence and pure flux by making every real a unity of dravya and paryāya.
- **15 marks:** Its genius lies in connecting many-sided reality with conditional judgement, but its material karma and omniscience doctrines remain philosophically contestable.
- **20 marks:** Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism: internally systematic, ethically powerful, and logically subtle, though vulnerable to external critiques of contradiction, soul-matter interaction, and unverifiable higher knowledge.

8. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 9 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.
2019	Q6(a)	20 marks	How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.
2020	Q5(a)	10 marks	Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?
2021	Q7(c)	15 marks	Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) 'Naya'.
2022	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.
2022	Q6(b)	15 marks	'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.
2023	Q5(a)	10 marks	"All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya) in the light of above statement.
2024	Q6(c)	15 marks	What is the distinction between Bhāva-bandha and Dravya-bandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.
2025	Q7(c)	15 marks	Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

9. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks) ANALYSIS:

9.1 10-mark answer

Define the key term precisely: anekāntavāda, syādvāda, karma, or bhāva-bandha.
 Give the doctrinal core in 3–4 compact points.
 Add one distinction that prevents confusion (e.g., anekāntavāda vs syādvāda).
 Close with one evaluative line or exam-relevant implication.

9.2 15-mark answer

Frame the issue: Jainism balances realism with non-absolutism.
 Body A: explain the doctrine requested (reality / sevenfold judgement / bondage).
 Body B: add structure—tables, ordered seven predicates, or bondage sequence.
 Body C: include one criticism and one reply.
 Conclude with a clear philosophical verdict, not mere summary.

9.3 20-mark answer

Open by linking metaphysics and judgement: many-sided reality requires qualified predication.

Section 1: define reality via dravya, guṇa, paryāya, utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya.

Section 2: show reflection in nayavāda, syādvāda, saptaḥaṅgī.

Section 3: if asked, connect to soul, karma, and liberation.

Section 4: critically assess pluralism, realism, and self-refutation objections.

End with a balanced conclusion: realism without dogmatism.

10. LINK-OUTS

- Carvaka.md
- Buddhism.md
- Vedanta.md
- Pramāṇa across schools
- Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique
- Indian Philosophy PYQ bank, 2018–2025

SOURCES

- *Tattvārthasūtra* / *Tattvārthadhigama-sūtra* (named without invented sūtra numbers).
- Chatterjee & Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced synthesis

The safest overall verdict is **qualified realism**. Jainism is realist because substances, souls, matter and modes exist independently of our descriptions. It is pluralist because no single substance or consciousness absorbs the rest. It is non-absolutist because finite predication captures aspects rather than the exhaustive whole.

Its achievement is architectural: permanence and change, truth and humility, agency and embodiment, ethics and liberation are integrated in one system. Its costs are equally systematic: taxonomy can become heavy; omniscience is difficult to verify; karmic matter creates an interaction problem; and the doctrine must reserve enough unconditional truth to state its own non-absolutism.

The final answer should never conclude "all viewpoints are true". The stronger conclusion is that viewpoints are conditionally valid when they track objective aspects and become false when absolutised.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The complete 2018-2025 route contains **nine verified topic-owned questions**. Match each question to its centre of gravity:

- Reality and judgement: 2019.
- Karma and liberation: 2020 and 2022.
- Sevenfold judgement: 2021 and 2023.
- Absolutism objection: 2022.
- Bound/liberated soul and bondage: 2018 and 2024.
- Pluralism and realism: 2025.

Use the answer architectures and directive decoder in the retained source material below. The full model solutions, MCQs and original practice follow immediately after the layered teaching.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall - final master matrix

Prompt	Recall spine
Reality	<i>utpāda + vyaya + dhrauvya</i>
Ontology	six <i>dravyas</i> ; five <i>astikāyas</i> plus time
Logic	<i>anekānta</i> -> <i>naya</i> -> <i>syāt</i> -> <i>seven bhaṅgas</i>
Bondage	passion -> <i>bhāvabandha</i> -> <i>dravyabandha</i>
Release	<i>āsrava</i> -> <i>bandha</i> -> <i>saṃvara</i> -> <i>nirjarā</i> -> <i>mokṣa</i>
Path	right vision + right knowledge + right conduct
Verdict	pluralistic realism with qualified predication

Complete the integrated and remedial MCQs in the practice section before using the final consolidated register notes.

PART II - COMPLETE SOLVED PRACTICE

Learning Design and Source Grounding

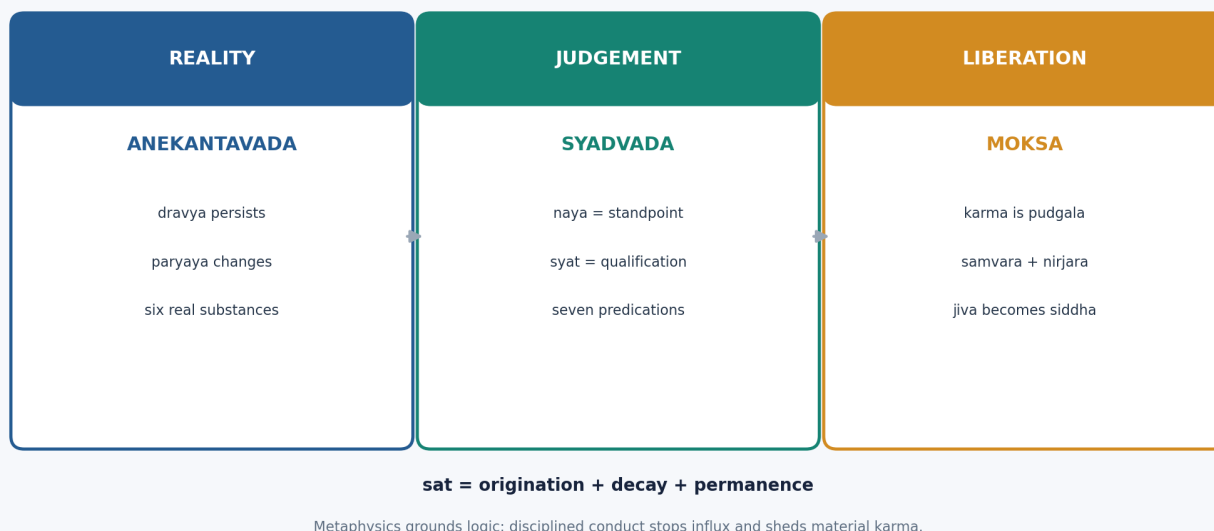
This package uses the canonical owner above, the complete 2018-2025 PYQ audit, Chatterjee and Datta's chapter on Jaina philosophy, and C. D. Sharma's critical treatment. The central learning design follows the actual doctrinal dependence:

MANY-SIDED REALITY
|
v
PARTIAL HUMAN STANDPOINTS
|
v
QUALIFIED PREDICATION
|
v
DISCIPLINED KNOWLEDGE + CONDUCT
|
v
STOPPAGE AND SHEDDING OF MATERIAL KARMA
|
v
LIBERATED, OMNISCIENT JIVA

Master distinction: *Anekantavada* is the metaphysics, *nayavada* is the standpoint discipline, *syadvada* is the rule of conditional predication, and *saptabhangi* is the sevenfold formal expansion.

Visual - The Three-Pillar System

JAINISM: MANY-SIDED REALITY, QUALIFIED SPEECH, LIBERATION



Jainism: many-sided reality, qualified judgement, and liberation

The same realism that permits permanence and change also explains why finite judgements require qualification and why bondage can be removed without destroying the enduring soul.

Rapid Retrieval Matrix

Prompt	Recall spine
Reality	<i>sat = utpada + vyaya + dhrauvya</i>
Ontology	six <i>dravyas</i> ; five <i>astikayas</i> plus time
Cognition	five knowledges; finite knowledge is karmically obstructed
Standpoints	substance, mode, general, particular, conventional, etymological, actual usage
Sevenfold judgement	is; is not; both successively; inexpressible; three combinations with inexpressibility
Bondage	passions cause psychic bondage and attract subtle karmic matter
Liberation	<i>asrava -> bandha -> samvara -> nirjara -> moksa</i>
Path	right vision + right knowledge + right conduct

SOLVED PYQ WORKBOOK - ALL 9 VERIFIED QUESTIONS

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: How do the Jaina philosophers explain bondage? What is the distinction between liberated soul and bound soul? What is the condition of the liberated soul?

Model solution

Jainism explains bondage as the real association of conscious *jiva* with subtle material *karma-pudgala*. The soul is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, but passions and activities obstruct these powers.

The mechanism has two inseparable dimensions. **Bhavabandha** is the psychic condition of delusion, attachment and the four *kasayas* - anger, pride, deceit and greed. It makes the soul adhesive. **Dravyabandha** is the actual influx and binding of karmic particles to the soul. Chatterjee and Datta therefore say bondage begins in thought: inner passion guides the material embodiment acquired by the soul.

Bound soul	Liberated soul
embodied and co-extensive with a body	bodiless <i>siddha</i>
knowledge obscured by karmas	<i>kevala-jnana</i> fully manifest
subject to birth, pleasure, pain and death	beyond rebirth and suffering
contracts or expands with embodiment	rises to <i>siddha-sila</i>
possesses active karmic accretions	all karmas destroyed

Liberation requires stopping new influx through *samvara* and exhausting old karma through *nirjara*, guided by the three jewels. The liberated soul retains numerical individuality; moksha is not merger into Brahman or extinction of the person.

Critical qualification: The account preserves moral continuity through a permanent agent, but the interaction of non-material consciousness with material karma remains difficult.

Why this earns marks: It answers all three limbs, distinguishes psychic and material bondage, names the causal sequence, and states the liberated condition without importing Vedanta.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory reflected in their view on judgements?

Model solution

Jaina philosophy defines the real as what possesses **origination, decay and permanence** together: *utpada-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktam sat*. A real substance persists through changing modes. This avoids the extremes of immutable monism and Buddhist pure flux.

Reality consists of six irreducible *dravyas*: conscious *jiva* and the five forms of *ajiva* - matter, media of motion and rest, space and time. Every substance has stable *gunas* and changing *pariyayas*. A gold ornament, for example, persists materially while bracelet-mode ceases and ring-mode originates. Hence reality is **anekanta**, many-sided.

Finite cognition normally grasps one aspect at a time. **Nayavada** identifies legitimate but partial standpoints; an error occurs when a partial truth is absolutised. **Syadvada** therefore prefixes predication with *syat*, "in some respect" or "conditionally". Its sevenfold expansion states:

1. somehow it is;
2. somehow it is not;
3. somehow it is and is not, successively and in different respects;
4. somehow it is inexpressible;
5. somehow it is and is inexpressible;
6. somehow it is not and is inexpressible;
7. somehow it is, is not and is inexpressible.

The jar exists as its present substance and mode, does not exist as another object or at another time, and becomes inexpressible when incompatible temporal-modal aspects are demanded in one simple utterance.

Shankara objects that opposite predicates cannot belong to one real and that conditional truth presupposes an unconditional doctrine. The Jaina reply is that predicates are indexed to standpoint, respect and time; contradiction arises only when these qualifications are suppressed. Omniscient knowledge apprehends the whole, while ordinary statements remain partial.

Verdict: Jaina judgement is not sceptical relativism but the linguistic discipline demanded by a pluralistic realism. Its strength is anti-dogmatism; its vulnerability is explaining the absolute status of *anekanta* and omniscience.

Why this earns marks: It links metaphysics to logic, reproduces all seven predications in order, uses a worked example, and adjudicates the absolutism objection.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon liberation?

Model solution

Jainism treats karma not merely as moral law but as **subtle material pudgala** attracted to the soul by bodily, verbal and mental activity under passion. Delusion and the four *kasayas* make the soul receptive; karmic matter then obscures its intrinsic knowledge, perception, energy and bliss.

The doctrine directly structures liberation. *Asrava* is influx, *bandha* binding, *samvara* stoppage of new karma, and *nirjara* shedding of accumulated karma. Right vision, knowledge and conduct, together with vows and austerity, weaken passion, stop fresh influx and mature or burn existing karmas. When all eight basic karma-types are destroyed, *kevala-jnana* manifests and the soul becomes a liberated *siddha*.

The theory gives ethical acts an objective continuity without a creator God. Its difficulty is explanatory: material particles affecting immaterial consciousness look category-crossing, and beginningless bondage is asserted rather than historically explained.

Verdict: Karma is the material mechanism that makes Jaina soteriology a liberation by subtraction.

Why this earns marks: It defines material karma, supplies the five-stage sequence, connects practice to metaphysics, and includes a precise criticism.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (*sapta-bhangi*) Naya.

Model solution

The sevenfold judgement is the logical expression of Jaina many-sided realism. *Naya* is a partial standpoint; *syat* qualifies a proposition by respect, time, relation or mode. Since a finite judgement cannot exhaust a real, predication must remain conditional.

The seven forms are:

Form	Meaning
<i>syad asti</i>	in some respect, it is
<i>syad nasti</i>	in some respect, it is not
<i>syad asti ca nasti ca</i>	in different respects/successive moments, it is and is not
<i>syad avaktavyam</i>	in some respect, it is inexpressible
<i>syad asti ca avaktavyam ca</i>	it is and is inexpressible
<i>syad nasti ca avaktavyam ca</i>	it is not and is inexpressible
<i>syad asti ca nasti ca avaktavyam ca</i>	it is, is not and is inexpressible

A jar exists as a jar here and now, does not exist as cloth or in a destroyed future state, and is inexpressible when its mutually indexed aspects are demanded simultaneously in one unqualified assertion.

The theory does not assert brute contradictions. "Is" and "is not" concern different aspects. Nor is *avaktavya* mere ignorance: it marks the inability of one simple sentence to state complex, temporally differentiated reality at once.

Critics call the scheme redundant or self-defeating. The Jaina reply is that seven possibilities systematically combine affirmation, negation and inexpressibility, disciplining speech rather than multiplying truth-values arbitrarily.

Verdict: Saptabhangi is best read as standpoint-conditioned predication grounded in realism, not as unrestricted relativism.

Why this earns marks: It defines the doctrinal chain, gives the exact ordered seven, applies an example, and blocks the contradiction caricature.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Jaina soteriology depends on its material conception of karma. The soul is intrinsically omniscient and blissful, yet passions attract subtle karmic matter that obscures these powers. Thus liberation is not divine grace or knowledge of an already non-dual identity; it is the actual removal of material obstruction.

The sequence is *asrava* -> *bandha* -> *samvara* -> *nirjara* -> *moksa*. Ethical vows, non-violence, restraint and the three jewels stop fresh influx; austerity and passionlessness shed accumulated karma. Destruction of knowledge-obscuring karma reveals *kevala-jnana*, and the fully purified soul rises as an individual *siddha*.

The theory strongly integrates metaphysics, ethics and personal responsibility without a creator. Yet material karma binding a conscious soul is obscure, and if bondage is beginningless the transition from original purity to obstruction is never explained.

Verdict: Karma gives Jainism a rigorous technology of self-purification, though its literal materialism creates the system's deepest interaction problem.

Why this earns marks: It focuses on "bearing", names the operational sequence, links vows to mechanisms, and balances explanatory gain with cost.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2022 Q6(b), 15 marks

Question: "The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating Absolutism." Critically examine.

Model solution

The objection targets a possible self-reference problem. If every claim is only relatively true, the claim "every claim is relative" must itself be relative and cannot govern all judgements. Moreover, Jaina philosophy treats *anekantavada*, the reality of substances and *kevala-jnana* as more than merely optional perspectives. C. D. Sharma therefore argues that Jainism makes an exception for its own teaching.

The criticism is powerful against a crude reading of Jainism as "all views are equally true". Classical Jainism, however, is a **realist non-absolutism**, not sceptical relativism. Reality objectively has many aspects; a *naya* is true insofar as it tracks one of them and false when absolutised. *Syat* indexes a statement to conditions; it does not dissolve its truth.

The Jaina may concede two levels. Finite discursive cognition is partial because karmic obstruction limits the knower. Omniscient *kevala-jnana* comprehends all aspects together. The unconditional thesis required is therefore minimal: reality exceeds every finite unqualified judgement. It need not be an absolutist proposition exhaustively describing reality.

Still, the reply carries a cost. If an omniscient standpoint validates the system, its existence needs independent support; otherwise it is introduced to rescue relativity. Further, the assertion that every real has substance and modes appears itself universal.

Verdict: Jainism cannot avoid all absoluteness, but it need not. Its coherent position is qualified realism: objective many-sidedness plus the fallibility of finite predication, not the absolute thesis that nothing is absolute.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs the self-reference objection, distinguishes relativism from non-absolutism, presents the omniscience reply, and concedes the residual burden.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2023 Q5(a), 10 marks

Question: "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina sevenfold judgement in this light.

Model solution

Jainism agrees that ordinary embodied knowledge is limited and standpoint-bound, but it does not reduce all knowledge to sensory empiricism. Its fivefold scheme includes *mati* and *sruta* as indirect ordinary knowledge, while *avadhi*, *manahpariyaya* and *kevala* transcend normal sense mediation.

Sevenfold judgement governs finite discursive assertion. Because reality includes enduring substance and changing modes, "the jar exists" is true from one time, place and respect; "the jar does not exist" is true relative to another object, time or mode. The seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility prevent a partial empirical judgement from becoming absolute.

The proposition in the question is therefore only partly Jaina. Human embodied cognition is commonly relative, but *kevala-jnana* is direct, complete and non-relative. Critics may say this exception is ad hoc. The Jaina replies that omniscience is the manifestation of the soul's intrinsic cognition after karmic obstruction ends.

Verdict: Saptabhangi is a discipline for finite empirical knowledge, not the final theory of every possible cognition.

Why this earns marks: It tests the quotation rather than accepting it, links knowledge classification to judgement, and identifies the kevala qualification.

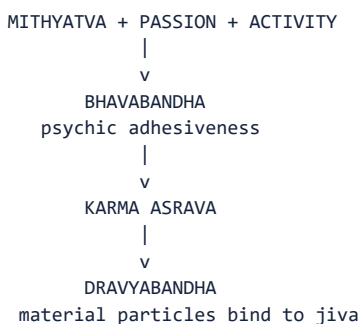
Solved PYQ 8 - 2024 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: What is the distinction between Bhavabandha and Dravyabandha?

Model solution

Jainism distinguishes the psychic cause of bondage from its material embodiment. **Bhavabandha** is the internal state of the soul: wrong vision, ignorance, attachment and the *kasayas* of anger, pride, deceit and greed. **Dravyabandha** is the actual binding of subtle karmic matter to the soul.

The relation is causal rather than merely classificatory:



The distinction explains why bondage begins "in thought" while still producing real bodies, capacities and experiences. It also structures release: right vision and conduct remove the affective conditions, producing *samvara*; austerity and equanimity promote *nirjara* of already bound karma.

The four parameters of material bondage - type, duration, intensity and quantity - show that inner passion shapes the exact karmic result. Thus ethics is not external obedience but causal transformation of the soul's condition.

Critically, the two-level theory avoids reducing morality either to mental intention or physical mechanism. Its weakness is the unexplained bridge by which a non-material affect attracts material particles.

Why this earns marks: It defines both terms, shows their direction of dependence, connects them to release, and evaluates the category-crossing mechanism.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2025 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Jaina philosophy is pluralistic because it recognises infinitely many individual *jivas* and five irreducible forms of *ajiva*, classified as six *dravyas*. It is realistic because these substances, their qualities and modes exist independently of being known. *Anekantavada* does not make reality a construction of language; it states that the real itself has many aspects.

Pluralism is disciplined rather than chaotic. Each substance has a distinct function: *pudgala* is material, *dharma* and *adharma* enable motion and rest, space accommodates, and time orders succession. Every real combines persistence and change through *dravya-guna-paryaya*. Hence Jainism rejects both monistic reduction and momentary flux.

Its theory of judgement follows the realism. *Nayas* select objective aspects; *syadvada* qualifies assertions; sevenfold judgement prevents one-sided predicates from masquerading as complete descriptions. Truth is perspective-conditioned but not merely subjective.

Critics raise three costs. Shankara argues opposed predicates threaten non-contradiction. Buddhist critics reject an enduring substance beneath modes. C. D. Sharma argues that combining partial truths does not automatically yield

whole truth and that Jainism absolutises its own relativity. Jaina replies distinguish respects and times, and reserve total cognition for *kevala-jnana*.

Verdict: Jainism is best classified as **pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism**. Its ontology is robustly objective; relativity belongs chiefly to finite predication. Its residual burden is to justify the omniscient standpoint and the unity of permanence with change.

Why this earns marks: It answers both labels, proves them through the six dravyas and objective modes, connects logic to ontology, and engages three named criticisms.

Integrated MCQ Loop - 24 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
1	Reality according to Jainism is: A. origination, decay and permanence together B. pure permanence C. pure flux D. mental construction	A	The formula preserves identity and change.
2	Which is a dravya but not an astikaya? A. jiva B. kala C. akasa D. pudgala	B	Time lacks the many-space-point extension of an astikaya.
3	Anekantavada is primarily: A. ethics B. scepticism C. metaphysical many-sidedness D. ritual pluralism	C	It concerns the structure of reality.
4	Syadvada is: A. denial of truth B. omniscience C. substance theory D. conditional predication	D	"Syat" indexes assertion to a respect.
5	Nayavada teaches that: A. standpoints are partial but may be valid B. all views are false C. only scripture is true D. language is impossible	A	Error comes from absolutising a partial standpoint.
6	The second sevenfold predicate is: A. somehow it is B. somehow it is not C. it is inexpressible D. it is and is not	B	The sequence begins affirmation, negation, then both.
7	Avaktavya chiefly marks: A. ignorance alone B. falsehood C. inability of one simple utterance to state complex aspects simultaneously D. silence as liberation	C	It is a semantic-modal limitation.
8	Ordinary human knowledge is limited mainly by: A. divine decree B. language alone C. non-existence of objects D. karmic obstruction	D	Knowledge is intrinsic but obscured.
9	Karma in Jainism is: A. subtle material pudgala B. divine punishment C. memory D. mere intention	A	It physically binds to the jiva.
10	Bhavabandha is: A. a liberated state B. psychic bondage through passions C. karmic particle only D. bodily death	B	It is the internal adhesive condition.
11	Dravyabandha is: A. ignorance only B. a vow C. actual material karmic binding D. omniscience	C	Karmic particles attach to the soul.
12	Stoppage of new influx is: A. asrava B. bandha C. nirjara D. samvara	D	Nirjara removes already accumulated karma.
13	The three jewels begin with: A. right vision B. austerity C. omniscience D. non-possession only	A	Vision, knowledge and conduct form the path.
14	Complete knowledge is: A. mati B. kevala-jnana C. sruta D. avadhi	B	It manifests when obscuring karmas are destroyed.
15	The liberated soul: A. merges into Brahman B. becomes momentary C. remains an individual siddha D. creates the world	C	Numerical individuality is retained.
16	Dharma-dravya means: A. moral merit B. scripture C. karma D. medium enabling motion	D	It is not ethical dharma.
17	Adharma-dravya means: A. medium enabling rest B. sin C. non-being D. obstruction karma	A	It enables rest as water enables fish movement analogically.
18	The blind-men-and-elephant analogy illustrates: A. material karma B. partial standpoints C. creator God D. momentariness	B	Each perspective captures an aspect.
19	Jaina realism differs from Madhyamaka because it: A. denies language B. denies all substance C. affirms real substances with modes D. accepts a creator	C	Anekanta is not emptiness of all essence.
20	Shankara's central logical objection is: A. too few dravyas B. karma is moral C. vows are impossible D. opposed predicates threaten contradiction	D	The Jaina reply indexes them to different respects.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
21	Sallekhana is ideally: A. passionless thinning at life's appropriate end B. impulsive suicide C. punishment D. sacrifice to God	A	Intention and absence of passion are decisive.
22	Five astikayas plus which sixth dravya? A. karma B. time C. liberation D. omniscience	B	Kala completes the sixfold list.
23	The four kasayas include anger, pride, deceit and: A. fear B. pleasure C. greed D. doubt	C	These passions intensify bondage.
24	The best classification of Jainism is: A. subjective idealism B. nihilism C. monism D. pluralistic realism with non-absolutist predication	D	Reality is objective and many-sided.

Rotation audit: A -> B -> C -> D repeated six times.

Remedial MCQ Loop - 8 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Correction
25	Anekantavada and syadvada are: A. metaphysical basis and linguistic-logical expression B. synonyms without distinction C. rival sects D. vows	A	Reality's many-sidedness grounds qualified speech.
26	"Somehow it is and is not" means: A. contradiction in one respect B. affirmation and negation under different respects/times C. truth is impossible D. the object is imaginary	B	Qualifications block contradiction.
27	Karma is attracted principally because of: A. space B. God C. passion joined with activity D. time alone	C	Bhavabandha makes the soul adhesive.
28	Nirjara means: A. influx B. binding C. right vision D. shedding accumulated karma	D	It complements samvara.
29	Jainism's soul is: A. permanent through changing modes B. a five-skandha stream C. Brahman D. body alone	A	It is a real individual substance.
30	"All knowledge is relative" must be qualified because Jainism admits: A. only perception B. kevala-jnana C. no knowledge D. divine revelation	B	Omniscience is non-relative.
31	Dharma and adharma dravyas are: A. merit and sin B. souls C. media of motion and rest D. creation and destruction	C	Moral meanings are a trap here.
32	The strongest residual criticism of material karma is: A. it lacks ethical effects B. it requires God C. it denies conduct D. matter-consciousness interaction is obscure	D	The causal bridge remains difficult.

Original Mains Practice

Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish anekantavada, nayavada and syadvada.

Model solution

The three doctrines form a dependence relation rather than a list of synonyms. **Anekantavada** is ontological: every real has multiple aspects because substance persists while modes change. **Nayavada** is epistemological: a finite knower approaches that complex real from a partial standpoint. **Syadvada** is semantic-logical: every finite assertion should be qualified by *syat*, "in some respect".

A gold ornament illustrates the sequence. The real includes enduring gold and changing ring or bracelet modes. A substantial standpoint stresses continuity; a modal standpoint stresses alteration. "The ornament exists" is therefore

true relative to its present form and context, while "it does not exist" may be true as a bracelet after remaking.

Confusing the doctrines makes Jainism look like verbal relativism. The metaphysics grounds the standpoint; the standpoint grounds qualified predication.

Why this earns marks: It defines each level, shows the causal order, uses one coherent example and prevents the standard synonym error.

Practice 2 - 15 marks

Question: Does saptabhangi violate the law of non-contradiction?

Model solution

The law of non-contradiction forbids asserting P and not-P of the same subject in the same respect and at the same time. Saptabhangi does not intentionally do this. *Syad asti* and *syam nasti* index predicates to different times, relations, places or modes. A jar exists here as clay-jar now; it does not exist as cloth or as the destroyed future jar.

The third predicate combines affirmation and negation successively, not as an unqualified simultaneous contradiction. *Avaktavya* marks the inability of one simple utterance to express complex indexed aspects together. Thus the sevenfold scheme is a discipline of qualification.

Shankara's objection remains relevant when qualifications are omitted or when Jainism claims one subject literally possesses opposed essential attributes. The Jaina reply relies on the *dravya-paryaya* distinction: permanence belongs to substance, change to mode.

Verdict: Saptabhangi is compatible with non-contradiction under explicit indexing; it becomes incoherent only when "syat" is reduced to decorative uncertainty.

Why this earns marks: It states the formal law, tests the third and fourth predicates, presents Shankara's pressure, and gives the precise Jaina reply.

Practice 3 - 20 marks

Question: "Jaina liberation is a metaphysics of purification rather than transformation." Analyse.

Model solution

The statement captures the Jaina view that the soul is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss. Bondage does not create a new essence; subtle karmic matter obscures the existing capacities of *jiva*. Liberation therefore removes obstruction rather than converting the soul into another substance.

The mechanism is systematic. Psychic bondage - wrong vision, ignorance and passion - attracts material karma. *Asrava* produces influx and *bandha* attachment. Right vision, knowledge and conduct generate *samvara*, while austerity and passionlessness produce *nirjara*. Destruction of obscuring karmas reveals *kevala-jnana*; destruction of all karma yields moksha.

Purification is nevertheless transformative at the level of modes. The embodied soul contracts or expands with bodies, experiences pleasure and pain, and advances through fourteen *gunasthanas*. The liberated *siddha* is bodiless, omniscient and beyond rebirth, though numerically the same soul. Hence substance persists while modes are radically altered - exactly the Jaina formula for reality.

The theory integrates ontology, ethics and soteriology without God. Its costs are the obscure interaction of soul and karmic matter, the unexplained beginninglessness of bondage, and dependence on the contested possibility of omniscience.

Verdict: Liberation is purification in substance and transformation in mode; the *dravya-paryaya* distinction allows Jainism to affirm both without identity-loss.

Why this earns marks: It interprets the quotation, reconstructs the full causal sequence, uses *gunasthanas* and *kevala-jnana*, and ends with a qualified synthesis.

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES - JAINISM

Reality: Persistence Without Stasis

- *Sat* = origination + decay + permanence.
- Every real is *dravya* with abiding *guna* and changing *paryaya*.
- Six dravyas: jiva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, akasa, kala.
- Five astikayas: all except time.
- Dharma/adharma are media of motion/rest, not merit/demerit.
- Best classification: pluralistic realism.
- Buddhist foil: flux without enduring substance.
- Advaita foil: non-dual reality with plurality ultimately downgraded.

Knowledge and the Logic of Qualification

- Five knowledges: mati, sruta, avadhi, manahparyaya, kevala.
- Ordinary embodied cognition is partial because of karmic obstruction.
- Anekantavada: reality is many-sided.
- Nayavada: finite standpoint selects one aspect.
- Syadvada: proposition is conditionally qualified.
- Saptabhangi: seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility.
- Avaktavya is not mere ignorance; it marks simultaneous expressive limitation.
- Trap: Jainism is not "all opinions are equally true".

Sevenfold Order

1. somehow it is;
2. somehow it is not;
3. somehow it is and is not;
4. somehow it is inexpressible;
5. somehow it is and is inexpressible;
6. somehow it is not and is inexpressible;
7. somehow it is, is not and is inexpressible.

Bondage: Inner Cause, Material Result

- Karma is subtle pudgala, not only moral bookkeeping.
- Bhavabandha: wrong vision, ignorance, anger, pride, deceit, greed.
- Dravyabandha: actual karmic particles bind to jiva.
- Four bandha parameters: type, duration, intensity, quantity.
- Eight karma-prakrtis divide into destructive and non-destructive classes.
- Strong answer line: bondage begins in thought but becomes materially real.

Liberation by Subtraction

ASRAVA -> BANDHA -> SAMVARA -> NIRJARA -> MOKSA

- Three jewels: right vision, right knowledge, right conduct.
- Five great vows: non-violence, truth, non-stealing, celibacy, non-possession.
- Guṇasthanas map progressive destruction/suppression of delusion and passion.
- Kevala-jnana is intrinsic omniscience manifested after obstruction ends.
- Liberated souls remain individual siddhas; no merger and no creator God.
- Sallekhana must be presented as passionless terminal discipline, not impulsive suicide.

Criticism-Reply Grid

Criticism	Jaina reply	Residual pressure
Opposite predicates contradict	different respect, time or mode	indexing must be explicit
Relativity needs an absolute thesis	objective many-sided reality grounds partial truths	anekanta itself looks universal
Permanent soul cannot change	substance persists, modes change	unity of subject remains contested
Material karma cannot affect consciousness	karmic pudgala is subtle and beginninglessly associated	category-crossing mechanism obscure
Omniscience is unverifiable	it is intrinsic cognition after all obstructions end	independent proof remains weak

PYQ Route Map

- 2018: bondage, bound/liberated soul, liberated condition.
- 2019: reality reflected in judgements.
- 2020 and 2022: material karma and soteriology.
- 2021: exact sevenfold judgement.
- 2022: relativism and absolutism objection.
- 2023: empirical relativity qualified by higher knowledge.
- 2024: bhavabandha versus dravyabandha.
- 2025: pluralism and realism.

Answer Spines

10 marks: define -> 3 doctrinal steps -> one distinction -> one criticism -> verdict.

15 marks: doctrine -> ordered structure/table -> objection and reply -> qualified judgement.

20 marks: reality formula -> six dravyas -> standpoint logic -> soteriological linkage -> named criticisms -> classification.

Final Traps

1. Anekantavada, nayavada and syadvada are not synonyms.
2. "Syat" means conditioned assertion, not probability alone.
3. "Is and is not" never means same respect and same time.
4. Time is a dravya but not an astikaya.
5. Dharma/adharma dravyas are not ethical merit and sin.
6. Karma is materially conceived.
7. Bhavabandha causes dravyabandha.
8. Samvara stops; nirjara sheds.
9. Moksha preserves individual soulhood.
10. Jainism is realist non-absolutism, not subjective relativism.